VERIFICATION REPORT FOR "IMPROVED COOKSTOVE GROUPED PROJECT IN PAPUA NEW GUINEA"

Document Prepared by SustainCERT S.A.

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Client	TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte. Ltd.
Project Title	Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea

Project Location	Papua New Guinea

Summary

A description of the verification of the project

The 1st SD VISta Verification of the project title "Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea' VCS ID – 4416, have been undertaken by SustainCERT with accordance to the relevant SD VISta standard, V1.0[/3/], SD VISta Program Guide V1.0[/3/]. Relevant requirements of the ISO 14064-2 and ISO 14064-3, as well as applicable criteria for consistent project operations, monitoring and reporting have been applied for verification.

The project VCS 4416 involves dissemination of Improved cook stoves in Papua New Guinea, primarily targeting low-income households to promote cleaner and more efficient cooking solutions. The project is implemented by TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte. Ltd., which also serves as the project proponent. Carbon finance underpins the project's strategy, enabling local engagement in stove distribution, household registration, monitoring, and maintenance activities. The project activity targets SDG 1, SDG 3, SDG 4, SDG 5, SDG 7, SDG 8, SDG 13 and SDG 15. The ICSs distributed, manufactured under the "Burn" brand, feature a stainless-steel insulated combustion chamber with thermal efficiency exceeding 25%[/18/]. These stoves are engineered to significantly reduce firewood usage and indoor air pollution by improving combustion efficiency and heat transfer compared to traditional three-stone fires.

The Purpose and scope of verification

Purpose:
The verification service provided by SustainCERT for the project activity SD Vista VCS 4416 is to perform independent periodic verification for the monitoring period 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024. The verification of the project is an independent review and ex-post determination by SustainCERT of the monitored SDGs that have been claimed by the project, against the SD VISta standard, V1.0[/1/], and SD VISta Program Guide V1.0[/2/], and host party criteria.

Scope of verification

The scope of verification is to establish/verify that:

- The project activity has been implemented and operated as per the approved registered SD PD and mentioned in the revised PD[5//8/].
- All the physical features (project technology) of the project are in place in accordance with PD and MR[/5/].
- The monitoring report[/8/]and other supporting documents provided (as mentioned in Appendix 1) are complete in accordance with the latest applicable version of SD Vista standard.

- The actual monitoring systems and procedures comply with the monitoring systems and procedures described in the registered monitoring plan[/5/.]
- The data recorded and stored as per the monitoring methodology including applicable tool(s) and, where applicable, the standardized baseline

The Monitoring Period:

The project activity VCS 4416 is undergoing 1st SD Vista verification from 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024 (both days included), under its ten-year fixed crediting period from 23-September-2024 to 22-September-2034[/6/].

The Method and Criteria used for Verification.

Desk Review:

Review of project information, monitoring plan specifically monitoring frequency, quality assurance and quality control system against the registered PD and revised PD[/5/] and applicable SD vista standard V1.0 and guidelines V1.0

Onsite audit Interview with the relevant personnel to confirm the implementation of the project by paying particular attention to the operational and data collection procedures, in accordance with the registered PD[/5/.]

- A detailed cross check of the information provided in the monitoring report against the relevant evidence such as data sources and technical specification of measuring equipment.
- A detailed cross check of the calculations and assumptions made for the targeted SDGs
- An evaluation of data management and the quality assurance and quality control system in the context of their influence on the generation and reporting of targeted SDGs.

The number of findings raised during verification:

A risk-based approach has been followed for the verification of the project. During verification 01 CARs, 09 CL and 01 FAR were raised during verification.

Any uncertainties associated with the verification:

The assessment team thoroughly reviewed the SD Vista PD/09/ along with monitoring report/8/ and the emission reduction calculation sheet/9/ against the relevant evidence and applicable VCS requirements, SDVista standard and VCS guideline V1.0. It has been concluded that there are no more uncertainties associated with the project.

Summary of verification conclusion:

The review of the Monitoring Report/08/, SDG Monitoring calculation sheet, supporting documentation, and the interview with relevant personnel during the on-site audit provided the assessment team with sufficient evidence to confirm compliance with the applicable criteria. SustainCERT confirms that the project activity, VCS 4416, has been successfully implemented in accordance with the Project Description and the applied methodology, VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, Version 1.0, in alignment with all relevant SD VISTA Program requirements. SustainCERT the monitoring procedures are in line with the monitoring methodology and the SDG Goals achieved during the current monitoring period are calculated without material misstatements. VVB's verification approach is based on the understanding of the risks associated with reporting of SDG parameters and the controls in place to mitigate these. VVB would like to confirm the group project will target 8 SDGs which are SDG target SDG 1, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 13 and 15. It has been confirmed based on evidence checked and submitted that project meets the applicable SDG standard requirements.

CONTENTS

1 VERIFICATION PROCESS

1.1 Objective

The 1st Verification of the project titled "Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea" VCS ID – 4416, have been undertaken by SustainCERT, as requested by TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd project proponent for the monitoring period 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024 (including both the days). The verification of project activity is the 1st periodic verification for the crediting period 23-September-2024 to 22-September-2034. The purpose of the verification is to conduct an independent review of the project information and confirm:

- The verification followed the requirements of the current version of the SD VISta Program Guide /02/ and SD VISta Standard/01/ to ensure the quality and consistency of the validation work and the report.
- The project activity is implemented in accordance with registered monitoring plan as mentioned in the initial Project Description/5/.
- All physical features (project technology) are in place.
- The actual monitoring systems and procedures comply with the monitoring systems and procedures described in the registered monitoring plan/5/, the applied methodology/7/ including applicable tool(s) and/or, where applicable, the approved standardized baseline.
- The data collection procedures and records are as per the monitoring methodology VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, V1.0/8/.
- The project complies with all the applicable SDG requirements and can claim for SDGs.
- The project targets 8 SDGs which are SDG target SDG 1, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 13 and 15 by distributing 19,206 stoves and reducing 13,443 tCO_2e.

1.2 Scope and Criteria

The scope of the verification is the review of the sustainable development impacts generated by the "Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea," its contribution to the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and the benefits for people, prosperity, and the planet as claimed in the monitoring report. To achieve this, the audit assessed the project implementation, operation, and monitoring system and procedures.
The scope of this verification is to assess the claims and assumptions made in the SD VISta Monitoring Report /05/ against the SD VISta criteria, including but not limited to the SD VISta Standard v1.0 /03/, the applied VM0050 methodology /08/, and other relevant rules and requirements established for SD VISta project activities. Additionally, as the project carries an SD VISta label under a VCS registered project (VCS Project 4416), the VCS Standard

and the project's PD and MR /56/ were also considered. The verification is carried out based on the following requirements applicable for this SD VISta grouped project:

- SD VISta Program Guide /3/
- SD VISta Standard /3/
- VCS Standard (v4.7) /1/
- SD VISta Program Definitions (v1.0)/1/
- Other relevant rules, including compliance with laws and regulations of the host country (Papua New Guinea)

A risk-based approach has been followed for the verification of the project activity. Identifying and assessing the high-risk area and ensuring the reliability of the project's emission reductions generated. The principles of accuracy, completeness, relevance, reliability and credibility were combined with a conservative approach to establish a traceable and transparent verification opinion. The verification considers both quantitative and qualitative information related to SDGS. The verification is not meant to provide any consultancy towards the client. However, stated requests for clarifications, corrective and/or forward actions may provide input for improvement of the monitoring activities.

1.3 Level of Assurance

The verification of the project activity is conducted by doing a detailed assessment of Monitoring report/8/, PDD, SDG impact calculation sheet/9/ and all the relevant documents, (as mentioned in appendix 1) of the report against the applied methodology VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, V1.0./7/ and SD VISta Standard. The level of assurance achieved for the project verification falls under a reasonable level of assurance. A reasonable level of assurance is a high level of assurance regarding material misstatement, but not an absolute one. Enough evidence was gathered by the assessment team to reduce the risk associated with the audit process.

1.4 Summary Description of the Project

The project activity, "Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea," VCS 4416 involves the distribution of fuel-efficient improved cookstoves to households in Papua New Guinea free of charge. This grouped project activity is a voluntary initiative, as host country laws do not mandate the distribution of ICS to households. The ICS technology is designed to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by improving the thermal efficiency of household cooking, thereby reducing the consumption of non-renewable biomass while improving indoor air quality and public health outcomes.

As per the registered and revised VCS PD and MR and SD VISta PD /04/, each ICS distributed is considered as a project activity instance. The start date of the project activity is 23-september-2024, which is the date when the first ICS was distributed under the project. During the current monitoring period (23-september-2024 to 31-december-2024), a total of 19,206 stoves were installed, replacing traditional three-stone fire cookstoves in the Southern Highlands Province. The crediting period of the project is from 23-September-2024 to 22-September-2034 (10 years).
In addition to reducing emissions, the project contributes to the holistic development of local communities and environmental sustainability by aligning with multiple UN Sustainable Development Goals. These include Goals 1, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 13, and 15, addressing poverty reduction through household savings, job creation, women's empowerment, access to clean energy, reduction in indoor air pollution, reduction in the consumption of non-renewable biomass, and a decrease in deforestation rates within Papua New Guinea.
The project caters to following SD Vista sectoral scope:

Sectoral scope 1 – Agriculture Forestry and other land use
sectoral scope 2 – Climate Change adaption
Sectoral scope 3 – Education
Sectoral Scope 7 – Health
Sectoral scope 14 – women's empowerment

1.5 Audit Team Composition

The audit team responsible for conducting the verification of the project demonstrates compliance with the competence criteria outlined in SD VISta guidance. Specifically, the team meets the requirements in the following areas:
1. Relevant Sectoral Experience: The team possesses documented and appropriate sectoral experience relevant to the project's context (Scope 3 – Energy demand). This includes familiarity with the types of project activities undertaken (e.g., Improved cookstoves, sustainable development, environmental management, etc.) and technical knowledge required to assess the validity and performance of the interventions. Such experience is critical in ensuring that the verification is both technically sound and contextually appropriate.

2. Social and Cultural Expertise: The audit team includes individuals with proven experience and understanding of the social and cultural dynamics in the project region or country. This includes awareness of local governance structures, customary practices, and social risks that may influence or be impacted by project activities. The inclusion of such expertise ensures that the verification appropriately considers potential socio-cultural effects and stakeholder interactions.
3. Transparency in the team composition: The team's composition and qualifications are transparently reported in the verification documentation, reinforcing confidence in the impartiality, capability, and independence of the verification process. All team members have

signed a COI for the project. Qualifications of all the personnel are in line with the SustainCERT internal Quality &Compliance team.
The verification team is as follows:

Team Members	Qualification	Desk review	Site visit	Report writing
Muskan Chawla (team leader)	SS- 3, TA 3.1 SDG – 1, 3, 4,5, 6,7,8,13,15	X	X (Remotely – for PP interview and stakeholders)[1]	X
Hayden Wagia (Auditor/ Local expert/ technical expert)	SS- 3, TA 3.1, awareness of local culture, language, social environment in PNG SDG- 1, 3, 4, 5,6,7,8, 13	X	X	-
Shivraj Sharma (Technical reviewer)	SS- 3, TA 3.1 SDG – 1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,10,11,12,13,15, 16, 17	-	-	-

Based on the available evidence and documentation, the verification team has been composed in accordance with the SD VISta requirements, demonstrating both relevant technical expertise and SDG expertise.

1.6 Method and Criteria

The method and criteria used for verification consist of following phases.
A risk-based approach has been applied for the process.
Desk review:
- A document review of the revised VCS PD, monitoring report/8/, SD Vista calculation sheet/9/ and other evidence like monitoring survey data/12/, signed user agreements/14/ , project distribution database/11/ (as mentioned in Appendix 2 of the report) were strategically reviewed against the applied methodology VM0050, V1.0/8/ and risk

[1] Travel restriction and security risk, lead auditor connected remotely
https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/traveladvisories/traveladvisories/papua-new-guinea-travel-advisory.html
https://www.bbc.com/news/av/stories-45654549

assessment was undertaken.
-Completeness check of SD Vista- MR

- The frequency of measurements, QA/QC procedures and other relevant documents are verified.
- An onsite audit for the project was conducted from 17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025.
- Interviews of the project representatives were conducted to discuss the implementation and operational status of the project with respect to the registered monitoring plan/5/.
- Discussion of QA/QC procedure, data collection, storage and transfer.
- Interview and visual observation on the condition of the project technology stove, baseline stoves, perceived opinion on SDG claims of the projects, grievances if any
- Resolution of all the issues and findings raised, and the final verification statement was issued.

Since, Section 3.2.6 of the SD VISta Program Guide (v1.0, dated 22/01/2019), "The public comment period should be completed before the start of an assessor's site visit, so that assessors may make appropriate enquiries onsite about any comments received. In the event that the public comment period ends after the site visit is complete, assessors shall give full consideration to any comments received and may need to return to the project site to do so." was not in compliance during the in initial submission, Since the site visit was conducted (17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025) before the public comment period (19/05/2025 to 18/06/2025 and a confirmation was taken from VERRA (via mail dated, 15/05/2025) regarding the new site visit requirement. As per VERRA Statement, "the VVB may need to do a site visit if public comments are not able to be resolved through remote interviews or in cases where the comments require actual checking in order to confirm if they are valid or not or in cases where the VVB has to interview stakeholders to come up with final conclusion." Since no new public comments were received, as verified from the project webpage, a new site visit was not conducted for the project, and original site visit conducted form (17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025) remains valid.

Sampling for the project verification:

The Sampling and surveys for CDM project activities and programmes of activities (Version 9.0)/18/ states under paragraph 28 that "When the project participants or the coordinating/managing entity have applied a sampling approach, the VVB may apply acceptance sampling as described in the steps indicated in paragraphs 29–38 below as part of validation/verification activities".

Since the PP has monitored parameters (Operational status of the stove and usage rate of the stove) through surveys, Assessment team conducted acceptance sampling in line with paragraph 30 and 31 of the sampling standard version 9.0/18/.

The Assessment team selected random sample of PP's monitoring survey records to check the acceptability (or otherwise) of the data for each such record with PP's sample records and determined if the PP's sample records meet the requirements.

Sample Size:

AQL	UQL	Producer Risk	Consumer Risk	Sample Size; Min	Acceptance No.
0.5%	20%	10%	10%	11	0

The Assessment team covered a total of 11 random samples across from ICS with each ICS itself a single project instances to confirm monitoring survey results. 3 oversamples were randomly selected to meet the uncertainty associated with the end users non availability.

All the households interviewed during the site visit were found to have inefficient baseline stove stoves using firewood in the baseline and confirmed that the project stove was operational. Fair emission reduction calculations are performed based on appropriately recorded usage during the monitoring survey[/12/] for the current monitoring period. The Assessment team would like to conclude that based on acceptance sampling approach the project participant's sample record meets the requirement.

1.7 Document Review

As part of verification of the project, the primary activity performed was the strategic review and risk assessment of the documents submitted using a dedicated protocol. A detailed review of, MR/10/ and SD impact calculation sheet/11/ was performed in line with SD vista standard requirement to check:

o The completeness of the information with reference to the register PD monitoring plan/5/.

o Review of project information, monitoring plan specifically monitoring frequency, quality assurance and quality control system against the registered and revised PD/5/ and applicable SD vista standard and applied methodology version.

o A review of the QA/QC procedures was conducted to make sure the implementation is as per the register PD/5/.

Project specific assessment against applicable national framework and legislation requirement/31/32/. All the other evidence reviewed is mentioned in Appendix 1 of this report. The cross checks between information provided in the Monitoring report/8/, VCS PD/5/ and information from sources other than those used, if available, the team's sectoral or local expertise and, if necessary, independent background investigations

1.8 Interviews

In accordance with SD VISta Program Guide (v1.0, dated 22 January 2019)/02/, para 3.5.6 "Assessments shall include a visit to the project site. The purpose of the site visit is to confirm the validity of the project description or monitoring report and to ensure that a project meets the rules and criteria of the SD VISta Program.", the VVB team conducted an onsite visit for the project from 17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025. The verification team conducted physical interviews with the end users, PP representatives, stakeholders and implementation partners as a part of validating the project description and verifying the information included in the monitoring reports and to gain additional information regarding the compliance of the project with the SD VISta requirements.

In addition to the end users, the VVB also conducted physical interview with

The following points were discussed as part of the interviews

- Project Design and implementation status
- Monitoring system,
- Roles and responsibility
- Baseline scenario and stakeholders
- Conditions of natural capital and ecosystem services before the project implementation
- Procedure for monitoring data collection
- Robustness and accuracy of data collection and transfer
- QA/QC procedures & training conducted.
- Criteria and compliance of new instances added during MP.
- Ongoing grievance mechanism
- Project technology users interviewed on site for household visit can be found in the table below.

S.No	End user name and serial number	Type of correspondent	Ward	Details discussed	Date of onsite Visit – Auditor
1	Helen Peter FDYRH3	Household (batch 1)	Beechwood	Operationality of Project stove, Kitchen observation to understand if project ICS stove was	18/02/2025 – Mr. Hayden Wagia
2	Relindah James FDYXZA	Household (batch 1)	Koropangi		

3	Kindeh yakala FDYRPB	Household (batch 1)	Kumuge	recently used, usage rate, Benefits of using project stoves and related SDGs impact, Repair/maintenance aspect, Feeback opinion on project and related communication channels to address the grievances, baseline stove usage, baseline scenario, smoke, employment opportunities were provided to the local people, training regarding the usage of stove, Money saving, time saving, firewood consumption reduction, Natural capita and economic condition	
4	Michael kapu ADYXF9	Household (batch 1)	koropang		
5	Penny tony NDYH9Y	Household (batch 1)	Kendal 4		
6	Nema Apa DYYRQ	Household (batch 1)	Station		
7	Aobu Mark ADYUER	Household (batch 2)	Yebi 2		19/02/2024 – Mr. Hayden Wagia
8	Patric Yama ADYUNE	Household (batch 2)	Yebi 1		
9	Tende kelely ADYSR7	Household (batch 2)	Yombi 2		
10	Issac kepo FDYXPC	Household (batch 2)	Yombi 1		
11	Luke Maka ADYGPE	Household (batch 2)	Nagop		

Based on the interviews conducted with project beneficiaries during the onsite visit and kitchen observations by the verifier team, it can be concluded that project ICS are actively used by the households and creating positive impact on the livelihood of the end users. Below tables outline the personnel involved in the interviews, along with their respective roles. The interviews specifically targeted individuals responsible for monitoring the project activity, data collection and management, as well as those involved in the quality assurance and quality control (QA/QC) procedures. The tables serve to identify the individuals interviewed and provide relevant information regarding their roles within the project.

Name	Designation	Topic Discussed	Name of the auditor
Geogina Tembi	Implementation partner	On ground project implementation,	Mr. Hayden Wagia

Benlee Jessie	Implementation partner	Beneficiary identification, Project stove distribution, grievance mechanism, stakeholder consultation, employee wellbeing, training and employment, SDG impacts, condition of natural capital and ecosystem services	
Eric Ulu	Implementation partner		
Miclael Kisombo	In country manager	Project implementation, QA and QC procedure, Training, employment, Project stove distribution, grievance mechanism , stakeholder identification, repair mechanism, monitoring survey and baseline survey, ICS usage awareness, SDG impacts, condition of natural capital and ecosystem services	Muskan Chawla Mr. Hayden Wagia
Brian James	Implementation Partner		Mr. Hayden Wagia
Samuel Wamo	Stakeholder and baseline stove users	Stakeholder consultation, baseline survey, Baseline stove	Mr. Hayden Wagia
Maria iki	Stakeholder and baseline stove users		

Jenenifer Andy	Stakeholder and baseline stove users	usage, baseline fuel usage, baseline fuel collection, grievance mechanism, condition of natural capital and ecosystem services	
Gabriel Landea	Stakeholder and baseline stove users		
Tiks Rema	Stakeholder and baseline stove users		
Philip Kera	Stakeholder and baseline stove users	Stakeholder consultation, grievance mechanism, engagement process and awareness, employment, feedback mechanism, baseline scenario and stove usage in baseline, condition of natural capital and ecosystem services	
Ruth Alalo	Stakeholder and baseline stove users		

Interview with the above personnel verified that baseline established and the information related to the natural capital and ecosystem services during the initial validation of the project remains valid in the current monitoring period.

Table 2: Project proponent and Project implementation field team interviewed from 17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025.

S.No	Name of the person Interviewed	Affiliation	Details Discussed	Audit Team
1	Dr. Gabriel Machovsky Capuska	TEM	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database),	Muskan Chawla Mr. Hayden Wagia
2	Cherie Sim	TEM		

3	Shameer Muhammed	TEM	grievances mechanism, baseline scenario, conditions of natural capital and ecosystem services	

During the validation of the project activity a FAR was raised, “In Line with Section 3.5.6 of the SD VISta Program Guide v1.0, during the first verification of the project activity, the next verifying VVB shall conduct an on-site visit of the project activity to reassess the following information provided by the project proponent: Project Location, Baseline Scenario, Stakeholder Engagement and consultation, Conditions of stakeholders at project start, conditions of natural capital and ecosystem services at project start.” Based on the FAR raised, the assessment team confirms that a comprehensive reassessment was carried out during the first verification. The following aspects were specifically addressed:

1. Project location: The VVB conducted an on-site audit and confirmed that all visited stoves were located within the designated project boundary in Papua New Guinea.
Verification was further supported by:
- KML files submitted by PP, detailing the geographical boundary.
- The distribution database, which included household specific coordinates and stove installation data.

2. Baseline Scenario: Assessment team directly verified the baseline scenario by visiting baseline households. Additionally, During the project household interviews, end users confirmed that their baseline technology consisted of inefficient open fire stoves. These findings were corroborated using a structured baseline questionnaire designed to gather data on pre-project cooking practices and technologies.

3.Stakeholder engagement and consultation, condition of stakeholders at project start: The VVB conducted interviews with:
The project proponent and its representatives,
Baseline users and stakeholders,
Implementation partners (local employees also part of stakeholders)
end users of the project cookstove and stakeholders
Interviews were conducted with all the above people and details related to stakeholders engagement and continuous grievance mechanism were discussed and also a the condition of stakeholder at the start of project was discussed with baseline scenario. Details related to feedback on stakeholders were also discussed during the onsite to verify the details related to stakeholder engagement.

4. Conditions of natural capital and ecosystem services at project start: The assessment team during the current verification conducted an onsite visit and interviewed following

people:
- End users – to verify the difference in the usage of project stove and ICS including firewood savings, smoke levels, safety and other project related aspects.
- Baseline and stakeholder – to understand the pre project situation and understand in more details of the project at the start
- Implementation partner and PP representatives- to verify the details related to household and distribution pattern.

It has been confirmed with the help of interview conducted that project activity has positively impacted the project. Additionally, to the above information desk review was also conducted based on the evidence submitted by the PP for stakeholder engagement process, including records of community consultations, training sessions, and awareness activities. Based on the the desk review, field verification, and interviews conducted, the assessment teams confirms that the FAR raised during validation has been fully addressed, and that the project location, baseline scenario, stakeholder engagement, and condition of natural capita and ecosystem services have been reassessed and confirmed in accordance with the applicable standard required.

On the basis of the information collected through above interviews and then further cross checked with the evidence submitted in the Appendix 2 of the report, helped assessment team reach to the conclusion the project is inline with the applied methodology[/09/] and SD vista requirements, thus a reasonable level of assurance is met.

1.9 Site Inspections

Site visit for the project was performed on 17/02/2025 to 20/02/2025.

Objective of On-site Inspections
- To verify physical deployment and proper functioning of Improved Cookstoves distributed in the project activity.
- To assess implementation fidelity to the PDD and SD VISta criteria.
- To confirm stakeholder engagement, benefit delivery, and project monitoring procedures.
- To collect data on environmental and social impacts in accordance with SDG indicators.

Methodology
- Structured site visits by independent assessors and project proponents.
- Use of checklists and interview guides aligned with SD VISta monitoring requirements.
- Ground-truthing data from Monitoring Report with field observations.
- Random sampling of households and staff involved in cookstove use, maintenance, and training
- Photographic documentation, direct interviews, and stove usage observations.

Locations Visited
- Southern Highlands Province: Focused on sites where 19,206 ICSs were distributed in that area. Samples were selected on random basis to visit and verify the details.

Physical and Organizational Aspects Inspected:
- Stove installation conditions and user adherence.
- Storage and transportation facilities.
- Records and data logs maintained by TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd.
- Field training sessions, stakeholder interaction procedures, and grievance redress systems.
- Gender representation in staffing and leadership roles.

Upon completion of site visit it was confirmed that the project is implemented as the registered monitoring plan and the reasonable level of assurance was met.

1.10 Public Comments

During the public comment period from 19/05/2025 to 18/06/2025, no public comments were submitted regarding the Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea.

1.11 Resolution of Findings

As discussed above, a risk-based approach has been applied for the verification of the project activity. During the verification, the assessment team identified the issues which could impact the accuracy and the credibility of the emission reduction claimed by the project. The detailed analysis of the issues raised the approach used to resolve these issues can be found in Appendix 2 of this report.

The Corrective Action Request (CAR) was raised if:
- Modifications to the implementation, operation, and monitoring of the registered project activity have not been sufficiently documented by the project participants.
- Mistakes have been made in applying assumptions, data, or calculations of emission reductions that will impact the number of emission reductions.

The Clarification Request (CL) was raised if:
- Information is insufficient or not clear enough to determine whether the applicable requirements have been met.

The Forward Action Request (FAR) was raised if:
- If the monitoring and reporting require attention and/or adjustment for the next verification period.

During verification a total of 01 CARs, 09 CLs and 01 FAR were raised. The details of all the issues communicated to the PP can be found in Appendix 2. The issues raised were closed successfully.

1.12 Forward Action Requests

During the validation of the project 1 FAR was raised information related to the same can be found in section 1.8 of the report.,

During the current verification a FAR has been raised related to SDG 1 monitoring

During this monitoring period, the PP has estimated the financial savings accrued by households due to reduced firewood purchases based on modeled data and baseline survey findings. Specifically, the PP calculated that an average saving of 1.04 Kina per household per day was achieved, resulting in an estimated total saving of 57,890 Kina across all beneficiary households. The calculation methodology and source references (i.e., baseline survey and monitoring spreadsheets) were reviewed and found to be technically consistent with the validated approach.

However, survey questions specifically addressing household-level economic savings were not included during the monitoring survey, with the rationale being that the short duration since the distribution of cookstoves (3 months and 9 days) was insufficient to yield observable changes in expenditure patterns. While this justification is acknowledged, the absence of direct beneficiary feedback represents a limitation in verifying tangible SDG 1 co-benefits.

Therefore, a FAR has been raised; The PP shall take the following corrective actions in advance of the next verification:

- Integrate survey questions into future monitoring surveys to directly capture information on monetary savings experienced by households due to the use of improved cookstoves;

- Report on the outcomes of these survey responses in the next monitoring report to substantiate SDG 1 contributions.

2 VALIDATION FINDINGS

2.1 Project Description Deviations

During this SD vista verification (1st verification) for the group project, as the project part of the VCS verification of the project, the GP underwent a methodology change, the group project activity was earlier registered with methodology VMR0006: Methodology for installation of High Efficiency Firewood Cookstoves v1.2. However, now the project is taking a deviation and changing the methodology to VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves V 1.0. The project activity has undergone detailed assessment as per the new methodology, and it has been verified that project is appropriately meeting all the criteria under new methodology, as mentioned in the revised PD. Following deviations have taken place:

1. **PM2.5 Monitoring Approach:** The project description initially required direct household-level PM2.5 monitoring during cooking activities. However, due to acknowledged challenges such as spatial variability, inconsistent low-cost sensor data, and the complexity of personal exposure measurements, a justified deviation was made. The project instead used standardized testing results from the Clean Cooking Alliance database, based on ISO Protocol 19867-1:2018 for the specific stove model, and compared these with baseline open-

fire cooking values. The comparative data showed an 81.24% reduction in PM2.5 emissions (from 943.40 mg/MJ to 177 mg/MJ). This literature-based method, supplemented with project-specific distribution data, provides a credible basis for estimating reductions. The approach is inline with methodology, therefore, accepted.
2. **Thermal efficiency considerations**: The project acknowledged that thermal efficiency of ICSs may decline over time. To address this, the monitoring plan includes annual Water Boiling Tests (WBT) under VM0050 v1.0 to incorporate degradation effects. For this first monitoring period, since all stoves were newly distributed, efficiency values were assumed at maximum, inline with WBT test reports. This is found to be acceptable inline with the evidences submitted.
3. **Woody Biomass Saving:** The project initially estimated biomass savings at 3.81 tonnes/ICS/year, but updated this using the methodology under VM0050 v1.0, resulting in a revised value of 3.70 tonnes/ICS/year. This adjustment is aligned with the improved methodological requirements, and therefore, it is accepted.
4. **Qualitative Evidence on Smoke Reduction**: To complement the quantitative approach, PP has conducted a Ground Monitoring Surveys that were conducted. Households reported a 100% observed decrease in smoke intensity, shifting from thick/dark smoke at baseline to lighter smoke categories during the monitoring period. Based on the observed results from the monitoring survey, the value is found to be accepted.
5. **SDG 5.4:** The parameter has been revised to the proportion of time used to collect the firewood, the baseline value has been taken from the baseline survey and project value has been taken from the monitoring survey data, evidence for both have been submitted and the values have been found to be acceptable.

All the deviations mentioned above are found to be inline with methodology requirement and SD VISta standard requirement, Therefore, a reasonable level of assurance is met.

2.2 Grouped Projects

The assessment team reviewed the procedures and evidence submitted to validate the inclusion of new project activity instances under the grouped project activity, during this monitoring period, PP has added 19,206 PAI under the group project activity. Table below mentions the assessment criteria for each of the conditions specified:

S/N	Criterion	Compliance	Assessment Opinion
1	Adopt and implement the project activities in the same manner as specified in the project description.	New project activity instances will be implemented in the same manner as described in the project description, extending	The assessment team has verified the distribution database/16/ and project ledger, and also during onsite visit it has been confirmed

		benefits, and reinforcing ICS adoption.	that project has been distributed as per the description in the PD and the same stove model has been distributed throughout. Therefore, the condition is found to be met.
2	Where appropriate, meet the applicability conditions of the SD VISta asset methodology applied to a project.	The project activity, as well as new project instances will apply the SD VISta asset methodology and adhere to the criteria set out in the methodology.	The project activity does not target any asset. There the condition does not apply to the project.
3	Are subject to the same scenarios at project start with respect to stakeholders' well-being as determined for initial project instance(s), where (per Section 2.1.5.2 above) the project must meet the criteria of Section 3.1 above.	New project activity instances will have the same baseline scenario, which was available during the start of the project, i.e., usage of open fire cooking methods in the households. Also, the instances will be designed to maximize the intended impact and preserve well-being, with monitoring and ongoing stakeholder consultations to ensure impact. Each household that received an ICS has been using the open fire cooking method in the baseline. Provision of spot audits and surveys enabled the assessment of type and depth of impacts	The assessment team conducted the onsite visit for the project; interviews were performed with the baseline users and project stove users it was confirmed the all the end users were using open fire inefficient stove in the baseline stove. Also, the survey results were cross, and data was also cross checked from literature review and it was confirmed that project meet the criteria. Evidence: VVB site visit/12/, PP survey results, Baseline study report for the area/19/.
4	Are subject to the same scenarios at project start with respect to natural capital and ecosystem services as determined	New project instances will have the same scenario as determined in the baseline scenario. All the new instances will also have households relying on wood fuels for meeting their daily cooking	During the current monitoring period, verification confirmed that all households included in the new instances rely on wood fuel as their primary cooking energy source, this

	for initial project instance(s) where (per Section 2.1.5.2 above) projects must meet the criteria of Section 3.2 above.	energy demands. All households that received an ICS, revealed using wood fuel for cooking during the monitoring surveys	has been also confirmed with the research studies available for the area. Monitoring survey/16/ data validated that each household receiving an Improved Cookstove previously used wood fuel, thereby maintaining consistency in natural capital dependency and ensuring comparability in impact assessment. Therefore, the new project instances meet the required scenario consistency for natural capital and ecosystem services, as defined in the original project baseline.
5	Are subject to the same processes for stakeholder engagement described in the project description.	The new project activity instances will be detailed during continuous stakeholder consultations, refresher trainings for Implementing Partners and feedback consider in secondary project activity design to maximize the intended impact and preserve wellbeing. The project proponent has ensured that there have been continuous stakeholder consultations, refresher trainings as well as surveys to maximize intended impacts.	The assessment team confirmed during the site visit by interviewing the implementation partners and stakeholders that the is proper grievance mechanism with toll free number mentioned on the flyers provided. Stakeholders can reach out to the TEM team. Additionally, it has been confirmed that proper trainings were conducted, as verified from the training records submitted. Therefore, Criteria is met. Evidence: VVB site visit interview/12/ Training records/17/

			Stakeholder engagement records/13/.
6	Are subject to the same processes for respect for rights to lands, territories and resources including free, prior and informed consent – described in Section 2.4 above.	The outlined Project Management (Section 2.3) will apply to each additional project activity. Project management for the current monitoring period complies with the structure described in Section 2.3 of Project SD VISta Design document.	The project involves distribution of improved cookstove, and does not involve land acquisition or displacement, and thus no risk to land rights was identified. All the end users involved in the project were well informed about the project there was awareness sessions conducted for the project and distributed was done on the basis of end user agreement signed. No grievances or disputes regarding land, territory, or resource use were recorded during this monitoring period. This ensures that the project continues to operate within a rights-based framework that upholds the principles of FPIC for all participating households and communities. Therefore, Criteria is met.
7	Have similar monitoring elements to those set out in the project description.	Additional projects will have equivalent monitoring plans and procedures as described in Section 3.3. The project has implemented the monitoring plan as detailed in section 3.3 and 4.3 of SD VISta DD.	It was confirmed that: Equivalent monitoring plans and procedures have been adopted for all additional project activities. Monitoring activities are consistent in scope, indicators, methodology, and

			frequency with those used in the initial project instance. The new instances employ the same tools, data collection protocols, and reporting mechanisms to track SDG contributions, cookstove usage, and household impacts. Field-level verification and documentation review confirmed that the project has fully implemented the approved monitoring plan, including stakeholder surveys, usage checks, and outcome verification aligned with the claims made. Therefore, the criteria is met.

Hence, it has been confirmed that the sampling method undertaken, conformance with eligibility criteria, start date of project, conformance with central monitoring and management system and Quality and completeness of evidence, data and documentation remain same as during validation.

3 VERIFICATION FINDINGS

3.1 Summary of SDG Contributions

The grouped project" Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea" is aiming to reduce GHG emission by replacing traditional cookstoves with highly thermal efficient Improved Cookstoves. The proposed project will contribute to 08 SDGs as U.N. sustainable Development Goals 1, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 13 and 15.

The following table summarizes the project's direct contribution to the SDG through the implementation of the project activities.

S.no	SDG Target	SDG indicator	Net impact on SDG indicator	Estimated project contribution by	Assessment opinion

				the end of project lifetime	
1	1.1	Goal 1: Amount of money saved by families that buy firewood	Implement activities to increase	The efficiency of changing from a traditional cookstove to a more efficient one will result in the consumption of lesser firewood that is usually purchased at high prices, hence reducing the economic burden of families that buy firewood under the project activity. The project activity has replaced 19,206 traditional cookstoves with fuel efficient ICSs, leading to an estimated savings of 1.04 Kina per household per day. By proportioning the number of households that purchase their firewood from the monitoring survey, an estimation of	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG. The energy efficient cookstoves helps in saving the amount of firewood used by the end users. This was confirmed from the end users interviewed during the site visit. During the current monitoring period, Project activity has saved around 57,211 Kina as verified from the evidence submitted. Evidence – VVB site visit/12/, baseline study result/19/, Monitoring survey published research related to area, SPEEC letter, dated Jan 2025

				57,211 Kina is saved during this period	
2.	3.9	Goal 3: Reduction of fine particulate matter (PM2.5) emissions within households to reduce air pollution within households in the project area.	Implemented activities to increase	Contribute to improved health and well-being brought about by reduced levels of fine particulate matter (PM2.5) emissions within households below the baseline emission level of 943 mg/MJ delivered2. Overall, a total decrease of 244 tonnes of PM2.53 has been observed during the project lifetime.	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG. The efficient stoves distributed helps in reducing the amount of smoke release. This was verified by the VVB by the means of Interview as well with the end users. During the current monitoring period project activity has results in 244 tons decrease in the amount of smoke released. Evidence: standardised testing results (following ISO Protocol 19867-1 (2018))/18/ VVB site visit survey records
3.	4.3	Goal 4.1: Number of	Increase	Contributed to increasing vocational and	The project activity involves

[2] http://catalog.cleancookstoves.org/stove_details.html?stove_id=stove_A8WGMJX

[3] The calculation method is demonstrated in the SD VISTa Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet made available to validators.

		youth and adults in formal and non-formal education and training in the previous 12 months, by sex		relevant skills of local individuals by providing non-formal education and training on issues related to climate change, with specific skill building in operations and surveying activities related to ICS distribution and its monitoring under VCS. During the project lifetime, a total of 24 local staff were trained in training courses. These training courses were conducted annually for all the staff to make sure that the knowledge transferred is up to date and the delivery of the project remains on a high standard. At the end of each training session, staff sat for an informal quiz to test their understanding of the training material. The measurement of improvement of learning	distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and have provided jobs and training to many local people. The assessment team also confirmed during the interview with the implementation partner that training was actually provided. Training records and certificates were also checked by the assessment team. Evidence: Training records (certificates, acknowledgement, records and photos)/17/ VVB site visit

				outcomes and skill development will be based on the passing rate of the quiz. The minimum passing rate is at least 70%, and if a staff falls below the mark, they will have to re-sit the quiz within the same day.	
4.	4.4	Goal 4.2: Number of youth and adults with technical and vocational skills, by type of skill within the project area.	Increase	Contributed to increasing the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs, and entrepreneurship. An estimated 24 local staff and personnel were trained during the project lifetime to conduct regular monitoring of the project sites for additional monitoring and maintenance of the ICSs and project activity. This is alongside training in how to use the ICS, its advantages, as	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and have provided jobs and training to many local people. The assessment team also confirmed during the interview with the implementation partner that training was actually provided. Training records and certificates were also checked by the assessment team. Trainings were given on the topic cookstoves basics, Community Engagement/

				well as how it contributes to climate change and the carbon cycle. The local staff will be annually trained to make sure that the knowledge transferred is up to date and the delivery of the project remains of a high standard.	communication, Cookstove health and safety, team leaders/cookstove ambassadors/ Field Assistant roles and responsibilities, Data collection tools, Health, safety and security. Evidence: Training records (certificates, acknowledgement, records and photos)/17/ VVB site visit/12/
5.	5.4	5.4.1 Proportion of time spent on unpaid domestic and care work, by sex, age, and location	Implemented activities to decrease	The project will reduce women and children's drudgery through time savings in reducing time spent on cutting, collecting, and carrying firewood from trees far away from households. Monitored 6.25% in the baseline scenario as per Tasman Environmental Market's Baseline Survey Report, participating households were	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG. The energy efficient cookstoves helps in saving the amount of firewood used by the end users, thus reducing the number of trips to collect the firewood. The project activity has resulted in Saving 1.07 hours per day because of project

				monitored to only Spent 1.78% of there time colleting firewood. As such, this decrease from the baseline scenario results in a total 1.07 hours per day across all participants during the project lifetime.	activity Evidence: Survey result/11/, VVB site visit /12/, baseline survey sheet
6.	5.5	Goal 5: Number of women in the project including managerial roles	Implemented activities to increase	Ensure women's full and effective participation and equal opportunities for leadership at all levels of decision-making in the project. During the lifetime of the project activity, a total of 24 local individuals that has been trained and hired for this project, 9 (37.50%) are female. Monitored as the fair and unbiased employment of women within the local team during the lifetime of the	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and have provided jobs and training to many local people. The project activity during the current monitoring period has hired 9 female employees. Evidence: Employment records/14/ and pay slips, VVB site visit interviews/12/

				project. The project envisages that 50% of its employees will be female.	
7.	7.1	Goal 7: Number of people with primary reliance on clean fuels and technology	Increase	The project contributes to increasing access to ICS technology with Burn cookstove installations in 19,206 households that have been using traditional three-stone fire, over the project lifetime	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and distributed clean cooking device efficient cookstove to 19,206 households. Evidence: Distribution database/16/, VVB site (to confirm the project location)/12/
8.	8.3	Goal 8: Number of people formally employed, by sector and sex under the project activity.	Implement activities to increase.	With the inception of the project activity, jobs will be created firstly for the distribution of ICSs. Personnel will also be trained in how to use the ICS, its advantages, as well as how it contributes to climate change and the carbon cycle. Further to that and aside from	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and have provided jobs and training to many local people. It has been confirmed that projects has provided 24 jobs during the current monitoring period.

				the monitoring done during the verification cycle, the project activity will also conduct regular monitoring of the project sites for additional monitoring and maintenance of the ICSs and project activity. In turn creating long term jobs for the local community, without prejudice of sex, age, occupation and persons with disabilities. During the lifetime of the project activity, a total of 2 full-time and 22 part-time local staff were hired. Out of the 24 staff, a total of 37% are females. All the staff will be annually trained to make sure that the knowledge transferred is up to date and the delivery of the project remains of a high standard.	Evidence: Employment records and pay slips/14/, VVB site visit interviews/12/

8.	8.5	8.5.1 Average hourly earnings of employees, by sex, age, occupation, and persons with disabilities	Implement activities to increase.	Contribute to an increased economic income by providing fair compensation per month for the employees performing the jobs created as part of the project activity initially during deployment and later during project monitoring. Compensation will differ depending on the job scopes assigned to each formal employee employed under the project activity and will be sampled based on this distinction. Individuals employed under the project activity will likely be community members who are currently unemployed or working in the informal sector with an average income estimated as K439/month (Bonilla, et al., 2020).	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG and have provided jobs and training to many local people. It has been confirmed that projects have provided 24 jobs during the current monitoring period, with part time 22 employees being paid 1,343 Kina / month. Evidence: Employment records and pay slips/14/, VVB site visit interviews/11/

				During the lifetime of the project activity, a total of 24 staff, 22 personnel were employed part-time. These part-time employees were compensated with an average income of (1,343 Kina / month) and is pro-rated where part-time employment is relevant	
9.	13.0	Tonnes of greenhouse gas emissions avoided or removed	Increase	Contribute to GHG emission reduction through an estimated reduction of ~3.20 tCO2e per ICS due to the replacement of baseline stoves with Burn ICSs over the crediting period. Over the lifetime of the project activity, a total of 19,206 ICSs were distributed, generating a total of 13,443 tCO2 eq.	The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the PNG. 19,206 cookstove have been distributed and generated 13,443 tCO2e during this monitoring period. Evidence: Distribution database/16/, survey records, VVB site visit and survey /11/
10.	15.2	15.2.1 Progress towards	Implemented activities to increase	Contribute an estimated reduction in	The project activity involves distribution of

		sustainable forest management through the increase of above-ground biomass in forests		removal of woody biomass saving tonnes of firewood per ICS per year, from forests surrounding the communities thereby leading to an increase in above-ground biomass in these forests. The above value is based on the difference between the amount fuel used with open-fire cooking (BCb,i,y) and the amount of fuel used with the ICS (BCp,j,k,y) based on the VM0050 Methodology. Over the lifetime of the project activity, a total savings of 13,446 tonnes of biomass from 19,206 ICS installations.	improved cookstoves in the PNG. 19,206 cookstove have been distributed and have resulted in saving of around 13,446 tonnes of biomass during the current MP. Evidence: Survey results, PNG research study/19/, VVB site visit to confirm reduction in biomass/12/.

Based on the assessment above that project meets the SDG requirements. Thus, a reasonable level of assurance is met.

3.2 Project Design

3.2.1 Project Objectives

The project has clearly defined objectives that are well-integrated into its design and execution framework. According to the information provided in the SD VISta Monitoring Report for the period 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024, the central aim of the project is to address household energy poverty by promoting the large-scale distribution and adoption of Improved Cookstoves across rural communities in Papua New Guinea. These objectives are not only stated clearly in the Monitoring Period, but they are also reinforced through:

- The operational rollout during the monitoring period, distribution of 19,206 stoves during the current monitoring period, as verified from the distribution database and KML file submitted.
- The implementation of training and awareness campaigns as verified through the training records submitted.

- Continuous end-user engagement and stove use monitoring,
- Data collection on social, environmental, and health indicators as verified from the survey records.

The project's objectives directly support and contribute to several Sustainable Development Goals, as outlined below and in section 3.1 in detail:

SDG 1: No Poverty

With the help of distribution of improved cookstove, project has contributed to the saving of the wood fuel thereby, reducing the amount of money spent by the end users on purchase of fuel.

SDG 3: Good Health and Well-being

Traditional biomass stoves contribute to indoor air pollution, which is a major health risk in rural PNG. The use of ICS reduces exposure to harmful smoke, improving respiratory health outcomes, particularly among women and children. This outcome is supported by user surveys and field feedback collected during the monitoring period.

SDG 5: Gender Equality
The project acknowledges the gendered impacts of fuel collection and cooking. By reducing the time women and girls spend collecting firewood, the project contributes to women's empowerment, safety, and improved time-use balance. Gender-disaggregated data and community-level consultations substantiate this claim.

SDG 7: Affordable and Clean Energy
ICS technology is a cleaner, more efficient alternative to traditional open fires. The project ensures access to improved energy solutions for remote and underserved populations, making clean cooking more accessible.

SDG 8: Decent work and economic growth
The project has provided training as well as job opportunities to the local people with a pay scale higher compared to the normal trend in the PNG.

SDG 13: Climate Action
The reduction in wood fuel consumption translates to measurable reductions in GHG emissions. According to the Emission Reduction Calculation Sheet, an estimated 13,443 tCO2 eq. has been reduced by the implementation of the project activity.

SDG 15: Life on Land
Reduced dependence on unsustainable firewood collection helps preserve local forest ecosystems. The project promotes sustainable forest resource use, contributing to land conservation and biodiversity protection in the surrounding regions.

Substantiation of Objectives:

The Monitoring Report:
Clearly restates the project's objectives and links them to each relevant SDG. Provides quantitative data (e.g., number of cookstoves distributed, biomass saved, monitoring survey responses). Includes qualitative insights from stakeholder interactions, community consultations, and user feedback that reinforce the relevance and realism of the stated goals.

The project has clearly stated its objectives, which are coherent, specific, and strongly aligned with relevant SDGs, same has been verified through evidence (appendix 2) and site visit observation and interviews.

3.2.2 Project Activities

The project activity aims at distribution of improved cookstoves in the rural area of the PNG.
The project employs locally appropriate, fuel-efficient biomass cookstoves as the primary intervention. These stoves are designed to:
- Reduce indoor air pollution, thereby improving household respiratory health.
- Lower firewood consumption through improved combustion efficiency.
- Decrease time spent collecting wood, especially by women and children.
- Reduce GHG emissions, contributing to climate mitigation efforts.

Project activities during the monitoring period included:
- Distribution of 19,206 units across multiple communities.
- Training sessions and user guidance to promote proper use and maintenance.
- Field surveys and stove usage monitoring to assess adoption and performance.
- Community engagement efforts to promote awareness and gender-sensitive practices.

These activities are aligned with the objectives stated under SDGs 1, 3, 5, 7, 8, 13, and 15, and are delivering tangible, measurable impacts in line with the project’s sustainable development claims.

The potential negative impacts identified during verification such as stove misuse, inequitable access to maintenance activities, or displacement of traditional cooking knowledge have been addressed through:
- Inclusive stakeholder consultations before stove distribution.
- Follow-up visits and technical support for proper stove usage.
- Targeted training for women and marginalized groups to ensure equitable benefits.
- A grievance redress mechanism, allowing communities to raise concerns and report issues.

No significant or unmitigated negative impacts were identified during the current monitoring period, as verified through interviews and review of grievance records.

The technologies and implementation measures employed by the project are well-designed, contextually appropriate, and technically sound. They are actively supporting the achievement of the project’s sustainable development objectives. Furthermore, the risk mitigation mechanisms in place are robust, responsive, and sufficient to address any potential adverse effects.

3.2.3 Implementation Schedule

The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in the rural area of PNG and has distributed around 19,206 cookstoves as verified from the distribution database and the KML files submitted.
The assessment team has verified the implementation status of the project through the project database and the monitoring survey submitted by the PP. Additionally, the audit team has applied acceptance sampling on PP’s monitoring survey for selecting the samples for the site audit. Hence, it is confirmed that by the end of the current monitoring period the implementation status of the project in PNG as mentioned under section 2.1.6 of MR.
The project’s official start date is reported as 23-september-2024 as verified from the first end user agreement. The first batch of Improved Cookstoves was commissioned on 30-september-2024, marking the initiation of physical implementation at the community level. Following the second batch on 31-october-2024. The initial monitoring period covered by this report spans from 23-september-2024 to 31-december-2024, aligning with the start of field deployment and ensuring timely data collection post-distribution.

Conducted prior to technology roll-out, consultations were held in Q2–Q3 2024, securing Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) from participating communities in accordance with Section 2.4 of the SD VISta standard.
Assessment team concludes the following:

- There are no material discrepancies between project implementation and the project description provided.
- The monitoring plan is implemented completely and monitoring system (i.e., process and schedule for obtaining, recording, compiling, and analysing the monitored data and parameters) is appropriate.
- There are no material discrepancies between the actual monitoring system, and the monitoring plan set out in the project description and the applied methodology
- All the ex-ante parameters which are used in the calculations of the emission reductions are consistent with the Registered monitoring plan.
- The GHG emission reductions or removals generated by the project have not been included in another emission trading program or any other mechanisms that includes GHG allowance trading.
- The project has not received or sought any other form of environmental credit or has become eligible to do so since validation.
- The project activity is registered under VERRA VCS&SD-Vista programme only.

In the view of the information’s verified above the assessment team is of the opinion that the project has been implemented as described in the project description.

3.2.4 Project Proponent and Other Entities Involved in the Project

TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd is the only project proponent for the project activity. Who is responsible for the overall development, implementation, and monitoring of the project. The proponent oversees the coordination of grouped project activity instances and ensures compliance with SD VISta requirements.
Core responsibilities include:
- Project registration and stakeholder engagement;
- Cookstove procurement and distribution;
- Monitoring and reporting (including data management and survey oversight);

Other entities involved:
Local Implementation Partners:
- Community-based organizations and facilitators were engaged to assist with stove distribution, training, and household monitoring at the local level.
- Their work ensured culturally appropriate outreach and real-time user feedback collection.
Monitoring Survey Team:
- Conducted baseline and follow-up household surveys.
-Played a crucial role in data collection, verification of stove usage, and feedback loops for ongoing learning.

The roles and responsibilities of the project proponent and supporting entities are clearly defined, documented, and appropriate to the scale and complexity of the grouped project.

The operational structure reflects sound project governance and promotes transparency, accountability, and local engagement.

3.2.5 Project Location

The project is implemented in the Papua New Guinea, targeting rural communities where the majority of households rely on traditional biomass (primarily firewood) for cooking.
Locations were selected based on:
High dependency on non-renewable biomass;
Limited access to clean cooking technologies;
Readiness of community participation and access for implementation partners.
Households participating in the current monitoring period were located in areas verified through geotagged records, distribution logs, and household survey reports. Additionally, a site visit was conducted by the assessment team to the location of the distribution of stoves. Therefore, It was found acceptable to assessment team and reasonable level of assurance has been met.

3.2.6 Threats to the Project

The assessment of the natural or human induced threats identified by the project to the expected sustainable benefits are discussed in the table below:

Nature induced threats		
Threats	Solution	VVB assessment
Continued deforestation and degradation make firewood an untenable source of biomass.	As much as the efficiency of the cookstoves coupled with the imminent scarcity of the wood fuel would support the use of G3 Burn rocket stove (also known as Kuniokoa Cookstoves) as proposed by TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd for this project, there is the potential that as the population continues to expand and there may	The risk of continued deforestation and forest degradation potentially leading to the unsustainability of firewood as a biomass source is a credible and well-acknowledged threat, especially in rural parts of Papua New Guinea where natural forest resources are under consistent pressure from both subsistence use and population growth.

	be a point when firewood becomes an untenable source. In response to this, TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd in country team will train end users to maximise the use of small twigs and branches, crop residues near the local communities they live.	The project has proactively addressed this issue by choosing to deploy high-efficiency G3 Burn rocket stoves (Kuniokoa Cookstoves). These stoves are specifically designed to function effectively with smaller-diameter wood fuel such as twigs, sticks, and agro-waste. Their combustion chambers ensure more complete burning, reducing the quantity of wood needed for cooking while delivering greater energy output, as verified from the manufacture specification and then cross verified form the third party lab accreditation. The implementation plan also includes: Community-level training to encourage use of smaller biomass (e.g., dry twigs, crop residues) rather than full-sized logs; Awareness campaigns emphasizing long-term environmental impacts of wood harvesting; Development of user behaviour change modules to instil sustainable collection

		habits among beneficiaries; Following this VVB also conducted a onsite visit to interview both end users and baseline users to understand the wood usage pattern, it was confirmed that ICS uses lesser firewood. Furthermore, no evidence has been observed during this monitoring period of communities being unable to access fuel or reverting to unsustainable practices due to stove inefficiencies or wood scarcity. The project has adequately assessed and responded to the threat of wood fuel scarcity resulting from deforestation and degradation. The combination of technology choice (Kuniokoa stoves), user training, and behavioural reinforcement represents a sound and proportionate mitigation strategy. Based on documentation review and field evidence, the assessment team concludes that the project has appropriately addressed this threat, and mitigation actions are

		being implemented effectively.
Human induced threats		
End users' lack of maintenance of ICS resulting in either malfunctioning of the ICS as designed or lack of use	TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd will conduct routine visits to end-user households at least twice a year in each main geographic areas that currently use the new G3 Burn rocket stove (also known as Kuniokoa), to identify potential defects in the stove's construction, maintenance, and sub-optimal use. To reduce this proposed treat, TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd's in-country team will hire, train, and supervise users that will involve visiting the end-user's houses every 3-months to monitor the use of the new ICS.	The risk of malfunction or abandonment of the ICS due to poor user maintenance or lack of engagement is a common and recognized human-induced threat in household energy interventions, particularly in remote and underserved areas. In response, the project proponent has instituted a robust, field-based engagement model that demonstrates a high degree of diligence and foresight. The approach includes the following key components: Routine household visits are conducted as verified from the monitoring results. A rotating in-country monitoring team is tasked with training, supervising, and advising households on continued use. A robust grievance mechanism where end users can reach out in case any maintenance is required. The evidence suggests that the risk of stove neglect or misuse is being

		actively and effectively managed.
Failure of Behaviour Change resulting in high levels of non-adoption	TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd will continuously research the impacts of behaviour change for successful adoption. Study outcomes, whether formal or informal, will be included in future training and community engagements to continue shaping knowledge, and enhancing positive peer-to-peer influence. Planned community incentivisation mechanisms to reduce the use of inefficient baseline devices and practices are explained below: Field assistants known as 'Cookstove Ambassadors' will actively interact with end-users from their allocated jurisdictions to encourage the use of ICSs and continuously foster awareness on the benefits of using ICS over open fire cooking methods. The increase in adoption rates will be monitored through surveys	Adoption failure due to inadequate behaviour change is a well-documented challenge in clean cooking projects, particularly in rural communities where cooking practices are deeply cultural, habitual, and shaped by generational knowledge. The PP has implemented following loops for the implementation of the project: The use of community-based field assistants known as 'Cookstove Ambassadors' is especially commendable. These ambassadors: Directly engage with end-users to promote regular use of ICS; Share health and economic benefits over traditional open fire cooking; Reinforce messages through peer-to-peer learning, which has been shown to improve uptake and trust in development interventions. The introduction of a 'Cook-Off Event', which rewards villages that show

	inquiring about the rate of stove stacking within the jurisdiction. Monitored results will be tabulated quarterly, and the village with the most progress adopting from open fire cooking methods will be awarded with a 'Cook-Off Event'. The Cook-Off Event is an engagement strategy in the form of a celebration within the village where TEM will conduct activities highlighting the ICSs' benefits such as the reduction of firewood consumption and the reduction in smoke generated during cooking. Cookstove Ambassadors will also present successful stories through knowledge sharing sessions with the event's participants. Additionally, TEM will work with Cookstove Ambassadors seeking successful testimonials from end-users benefiting from clean	high adoption, combines social recognition with data-driven performance evaluation—an effective dual-incentive strategy. The VVB concludes that the project has: Accurately identified the threat of behaviour-driven non-adoption; Taken substantial and continuous steps to address it; Shown positive indicators of adoption and behaviour change. Evidence: Training records, Cook off records Discussion with stakeholders during site visit, continuous grievance mechanism

	cooking practices through the use of ICSs that can be converted into short form videos to capture broader social media audiences. Non-adopters, where identified, will also be engaged to understand the potential barriers preventing them to adopt the use of the ICS. These outcomes and conclusions will be useful to improve future training events with the goal of avoiding miss-information.	
ICS Projects and distributions are not shown to have an increased impact on household uptake	Time savings and increased health benefits are co-benefits from the adoption of ICSs will be incentives to increase their uptake. In response to this, TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd will conduct trainings highlighting how time saving, health benefits, previous users' positive experiences are important factors for large scale adoption.	The risk that ICS distributions may not directly lead to sustained household adoption is a valid and well-recognized implementation barrier. Adoption of ICS (Improved Cookstove) technology typically depends not just on availability but also on perceived value, ease of use, and cultural acceptance. The projects identifies and leverages co-benefits such as: Time savings from faster cooking.

		Improved health outcomes from reduced indoor air pollution. Ease of maintenance and usability; PP Plans to deliver targeted training sessions focused on demonstrating tangible user benefits. These trainings aim to: Increase community awareness of the real-world value of the ICS technology; Strengthen trust in the intervention by featuring positive experiences from past users; Reinforce the importance of long-term adoption rather than one-time distribution. Evidence: training and awareness campaigns records By highlighting these benefits, the project not only raises awareness but also addresses psychosocial barriers that often hinder adoption The monitoring report clearly states the implementation of structured outreach activities including:

		Cook-Off Events and public demonstrations; Community engagement activities emphasizing real-life impact; Consistent end-user feedback incorporation. These events helps in verifying the behaviour centric approaches. The VVB confirms that the project has adequately identified the threat of distribution not equating to adoption and has implemented a strong mitigation framework focused on user experience and community-based promotion.

3.2.7 Benefit Permanence

The following documents are assessed by the verification team to verify the project's benefit after project activities cease.
- Project database
- Monitoring survey records
- Stakeholder Consultation Meetings
- Training records
- End users agreement
- Literature review
- End users, Implementation partners and stakeholder interviews during Site visit

Based on above review, The project has clearly demonstrated proactive steps to maintain and enhance the long-term sustainability of benefits beyond the active implementation period.

Assessment:

1. Capacity building and local ownership: The project incorporates continuous training

efforts targeting community awareness on environmental, health, and resiliency co-benefits of ICS adoption. This reinforces user motivation for long-term use and aligns well with SDG-linked behaviour change targets. The assessment team finds this measure to be both appropriate and impactful, especially for rural contexts where knowledge gaps often undermine sustained technology adoption.

2. Formal Educational Partnerships: The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Western Pacific University introduces an academic partnership component, engaging students in sustainability education and community-based implementation. This academic linkage provides both technical support and capacity-building, enhancing project resilience and benefit durability.

3. Youth and Community Involvement: Engagement of university students and designation of ICS ambassadors for outreach at local schools demonstrates the project's forward-thinking design. These interventions foster long-term adoption through education and community ownership critical for behaviour-driven interventions like ICS.

Behavioural Reinforcement and Ownership: The emphasis on fostering a sense of ownership, starting from youth education to household-level awareness, is a strong design element that enhances permanence. First-hand health and economic co-benefits serve as reinforcing factors likely to continue encouraging ICS use even after project completion.

Based on the above evidence and detailed, the assessment team concludes that the measures outlined in the monitoring report are comprehensive, appropriate, and likely to achieve the intended benefit permanence. The layered strategy encompassing technical support, educational outreach, behavioural incentives, and stakeholder engagement creates a robust framework for sustaining project outcomes beyond the verification period.

3.3 Stakeholder Engagement

3.3.1 Stakeholder Consultation and Adaptive Management

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the project, from 23/09/2024–31/12/2024. The initial stakeholder consultation in the southern Highlands Province was from 13 March 2023. Multiple rounds of stakeholder engagement were conducted during the monitoring period: (i) staff training from 08–11 July 2024; (ii) household registration from 19 August–31 October 2024; (iii) distribution follow-ups from 23 September–31 October 2024; and (iv) household survey from 15–17 January 2025. All consultations were documented in the MR and verified through field evidence.

Evidence verified:
- Monitoring Report – sections on stakeholder engagement, feedback mechanisms, and

adaptive management practices.
- Records of community consultation meetings, including attendance registers, meeting minutes, and photographic evidence.
- Household survey results and feedback logs maintained by field teams.
- Evidence of communication channels, including field liaison officer reports, distribution event records, and follow-up visits.
- Training records for local staff on communication and grievance handling.
- Interviews with project representatives and sampled beneficiaries during on-site verification (17/02/2025–20/02/2025).

Communication and consultation Process:
The project has implemented clear, multi-level consultation and communication processes to engage with stakeholders during the design, implementation, and monitoring phases. Key steps include:
- Recruitment of Local Project Staff: Community-based agents were trained to serve as liaisons and monitors, ensuring effective and consistent engagement as verified from training records/17/.
- Pre-distribution Engagement: Before ICS units were deployed, communities were informed about the benefits of clean cooking, health risks of traditional stoves, and user expectations, as verified from the baseline survey reports and stakeholder engagement documents.
- Household-Level Feedback Mechanisms: Participating households were surveyed during the monitoring period to gather feedback on stove use, satisfaction, health perceptions, and wood collection patterns.
- Village-Level Leadership Involvement: The project collaborated with village elders and local authorities, particularly in remote highland communities, to tailor implementation to cultural contexts.
These processes reflect a robust and ongoing stakeholder engagement strategy
Ongoing Consultation and Adaptive Management: The project continues to prioritize consultation through:
Field-based monitors who act as local points of contact;
Continuous impact surveys that assess social, environmental, and economic outcomes;
Plans for expanded female engagement and inclusive training practices;
Commitment to improve stove durability and user experience, based on direct community feedback.
This approach ensures that the project remains responsive and adaptive to stakeholder needs.

It was also conformed during on site visit that project has implemented robust grievance mechanism and a proper ongoing communication with stakeholders. Stakeholders can reach out to the PP through any of the following means:

- Official website - https://www.tasmanenvironmental.com.au/pngcookstoves/
- email address - pngcookstoves@tem.com.au
- Toll free mobile number - +675 7262 3864 (also mentioned on the awareness flyer distributed to the end user by the PP in line with clarification 2 to the methodology)

The grievance procedure includes registration and tracking of complaints by the in-country project manager and resolution with the support of field assistants using traditional and customary approaches. The verification team finds the GRM to be appropriate, accessible, and consistent with VCS SD vista Program requirements. This was confirmed through interviews with project staff and a review of field documentation. Based on this evidence, it is concluded that the grievance redress process is in place, functional, and no resolution actions were required during this period is crucial to emphasize that the responsibility for addressing grievances related to the grouped project activity is shared between the local implementation partners and the project proponent, as verified based on interviews. It was also confirmed that there was no major feedback received by the project that could impact the project implementation in the region.

Conclusion:
The stakeholder consultation and adaptive management practices of the PNG Improved Cookstove Project are fully compliant with SD VISta requirements. The verification team concludes that the project:
- Has implemented inclusive and culturally appropriate consultation strategies;
- Actively considers stakeholder input in decision-making;
- Maintains mechanisms to adapt and improve based on ongoing feedback.

This supports a high level of credibility, transparency, and alignment with the sustainable development goals targeted by the project.

3.3.2 Anti-Discrimination

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established strong procedural safeguards to ensure that all implementation activities are free from discrimination, harassment, and exploitation.
Evidence verified:
Employee handbook for the procedure set in place for Code of conduct.
Staff Training records
VVB site visit interview with Implementation partner and local employee
Assessment:
Code of Conduct: All project personnel are required to adhere to a code of conduct explicitly prohibiting discrimination, harassment, and any form of abuse as verified form handbook and site visit interview with PP and its personnel.
Training and Orientation: Staff involved in stove distribution and household engagement receive training on anti-discrimination, sexual harassment prevention, and culturally respectful interaction particularly important in rural highland regions of PNG.

Based on the above evidence and assessment is has been checked and confirmed that TEM does not discriminate based on race, age, colour, sex, national origin, physical or mental disability, or religion. Processes are in place to prevent discriminatory behaviour or harassment by any entities involved in implementation. Grievance procedure has also been checked, and it has been observed that there is case related discrimination. CL 05 was raised and successfully closed.

3.3.3 Worker Training

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established strong procedural safeguards to ensure that all implementation activities were performed trained personnel.
Evidence verified:
- Training Slides
- Training photos
- Training Acknowledgement Form
- Training certificate
- Onsite audit interview to verify the training records
- Field training register

Assessment
1. Overview of Training and Orientation Activities
The project implemented a comprehensive, structured training program for local workers employed in field activities. Key training sessions were delivered between 8th and 11th July 2024, prior to project launch, and covered the following core modules:
- Introduction to Improved Cookstoves
- Community Engagement and Communication
- Health and Safety Considerations
- Roles and Responsibilities for Field Staff
- Data Collection and Monitoring Tools
- Personal and Community Security

The training was organized by TEM PNG Limited, and certificates were issued upon successful completion and assessment, confirming formal participation and evaluation.
24 local individuals were recruited and trained during the first monitoring period (2 full-time, 22 part-time).
Each training concluded with a quiz to assess knowledge retention. Staff were required to score at least 70% to pass. Any who failed were offered same-day remediation and retesting.
2. Special Focus on Inclusivity and Skill Building
The project has made intentional efforts to include marginalized and underrepresented groups:
- 37.50% of staff are female, with a public commitment to reaching 50% in future rounds.

- Local hires were prioritized, especially individuals from rural highland communities, including those without formal education backgrounds.
- Skills taught are practically useful and locally relevant, such as:
- Device handling (ICS installation)
- Communication in native languages for awareness raising
- Data collection and survey methods
These efforts contribute meaningfully to building local capacity and long-term employment potential beyond the project.

Evidence from Observations

- Both the SD VISta and VCS verification reports confirm that:
- Training materials were documented and available for review.
- Observations made during site visits aligned with the training content (i.e., staff demonstrated technical competency and consistent messaging to households).

- No discrepancies or gaps in training delivery were reported.

Conclusion:
The project has developed and executed an effective and inclusive worker training program, meeting the SD VISta requirements for:
- Local capacity-building
- Orientation of new workers
- Engagement of vulnerable and marginalized populations
- Skills development relevant to the project and beyond
The verification team concludes that the training provided is appropriate, inclusive, and impactful, and that measures for new worker orientation are sufficient and robust.

3.3.4 Equal Work Opportunities

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established following procedure:
1. Assessment of Hiring Practices: The project's hiring strategy and employment processes demonstrate a clear commitment to non-discriminatory, inclusive, and equitable employment. During the monitoring period, 24 local individuals were recruited (2 full-time, 22 part-time), with hiring based on local presence, capacity, and willingness to serve in community-facing roles.
- Employment opportunities were extended regardless of gender, ethnicity, or educational background, prioritizing community familiarity and trust.
- No formal barriers to participation were identified in the hiring process.
Assessment team verified the employee hand book for further verify the company policy.
2. Inclusion of Marginalized and Vulnerable Populations: The project demonstrates sensitivity toward improving access to work for women and other underrepresented

groups:
- 37.50% of the workforce is female. While this is short of the stated 50% target, it reflects a substantial effort in a context where formal female employment is limited.
- Hiring practices favoured community-based recruitment, which enabled participation by individuals with limited formal training but strong cultural and geographic alignment.
- Project roles offered include Team Leaders, Field Assistants, and Ambassadors, some of which were filled by women and youth.

3. Site Visit Observations and Documentation Review:
- Site visits confirmed diversity among staff engaged in field operations.
- Interviewed personnel reported feeling included and empowered by the employment opportunity.
- No grievances or claims of exclusion or favouritism were documented or observed.

All hiring records reviewed (including training certificates and staff rosters) support the claim of fair access and opportunity.

Conclusion:
The project provides equal employment opportunities to all stakeholders, including women, marginalized, and vulnerable populations. Its approach to hiring is:
- Inclusive
- Locally focused
- Skills and potential-based rather than qualification-exclusive
The verification team concludes that the project is compliant with SD VISta equal opportunity requirements and is making continuous progress toward gender balance and inclusive employment.

3.3.5 Workers’ Rights

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established following procedure:
1. Alignment with ILO Core Labour Principles
The project’s employment policies and field practices reflect conformance with the core labor standards as outlined in the International Labour Organization’s (ILO) eight fundamental conventions, which include:
- Freedom of association and collective bargaining
- Elimination of forced or compulsory labor
- Abolition of child labor
- Elimination of discrimination in employment

2. Based on the documentation reviewed:
- Workers are hired voluntarily, with no indications of coercion or debt-related labor.
- No child labor was observed or reported. All staff were of legal working age.
- Clear, non-discriminatory recruitment and compensation practices were in place.

- There is no restriction on freedom of expression or community-level organization among workers.

3. Awareness of Rights and Legal Compliance:
- Staff were trained on worker conduct, rights, and grievance mechanisms as part of the initial orientation (July 2024 training session/17/).
- Project implementers provided all workers with verbal briefings and documentation regarding:

  - Workplace behaviour
  - Health and safety expectations
  - How to raise concerns or complaints confidentially

- No worker complaints or rights violations were reported during the monitoring period.

In addition, the project operates within the legal labor framework of Papua New Guinea, which protects against discrimination, child labor, and unsafe working conditions. The project's practices are consistent with these national regulations.

3. Evidence from Site Visits and Staff Feedback:
- Site observations confirmed safe and respectful working conditions.
- Workers expressed satisfaction with their employment and indicated that they had been adequately informed of their rights and responsibilities.
- There was evidence of supportive team dynamics, with field leaders accessible to support or escalate issues.

Conclusion: The project is in full alignment with the ILO Core Labour Conventions and national labor laws. Training, documentation, and field implementation all support ethical employment and labor rights awareness.
The verification team concludes that the project has adequately informed workers of their rights, and demonstrates conformance with international labor standards and SD VISta requirements under Criterion 3.3.5. CL 06 was raised and closed successfully.

3.3.6 Occupational Safety Assessment

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established following procedure:
1. Measures to Mitigate Occupational Risk: The project implemented a clear set of health and safety protocols to identify and mitigate occupational risks faced by field staff and stakeholders during cookstove distribution and monitoring activities. These included:
- Pre-deployment safety training covering:

  - Stove handling and installation techniques to reduce physical strain and injury risk/17/

- Community-based safety considerations, particularly for remote terrain and travel safety issues/29/.

2. Stakeholder Awareness and Communication: All field workers were briefed on their rights to safe working conditions and trained on:
- Identifying environmental risks (e.g., unstable home structures, remote terrain)
- Dealing with hostile or unsafe community interactions
- How and when to stop work if safety conditions are compromised

The training was culturally adapted and conducted in both English and Tok Pisin to ensure full understanding. Stakeholders (household participants) were also informed about basic stove usage safety, as part of the education component accompanying distribution.

3. Documentation and Site Visit Observations

-Site visits confirmed safe working behaviours by trained staff (e.g., proper lifting, stove demonstration techniques).
- No incidents of injury or unsafe working conditions were reported during the monitoring period, as verified from the grievance records and on site interview.
- The occupational risk mitigation measures described in the project description were observed to be fully implemented in practice, and no gaps or deficiencies were identified during verification.

Conclusion:
The project has implemented comprehensive and context-appropriate occupational safety measures that align with the SD VISta Standard. Staff were adequately trained, informed of risks, and empowered to work safely and responsibly.
The verification team concludes that the project has met all occupational safety assessment requirements, and has taken necessary steps to minimize stakeholder risk during implementation.

3.3.7 Feedback and Grievance Redress Procedure

The project activity is undergoing its first verification under the monitoring period. The project has established following procedure:

1. Availability and Accessibility of the Procedure: The project has established a publicly available feedback and grievance redress mechanism, as outlined in the Monitoring Report and confirmed during verification. Key elements include:
- Multiple accessible channels for submitting feedback or grievances:
  - In-person through field teams
  - Via contact information provided during stove distribution
  - Through community focal points and leaders

The grievance process was explained to beneficiaries during household engagements and reinforced in project training sessions, it was verified during the onsite interview by VVB. The system is actively promoted to ensure all stakeholders are aware of their rights to raise concerns anonymously and without fear of retaliation. Grievance record was reviewed and found no concerns were found. Feedback related to the project was as asked during the VVB site visit as well and observed no concerns were raised.

2. Procedure Implementation and Use: During the verification period:
- No formal grievances were recorded, which was confirmed via review of project logs and staff interviews.
- Informal feedback (e.g., stove usability, demonstration clarity) was collected during monitoring visits and community interactions.
- Where feedback was received, the project team responded by adjusting training techniques and clarifying installation procedures demonstrating the system's use for adaptive management.
Although no major issues were escalated, the feedback loop was functional and responsive, consistent with project documentation.

3. Transparency and Publicity of Results: The grievance procedure, while largely handled at field level, includes internal documentation of all received concerns, as reviewed by project staff during the monitoring period. There is no evidence of complaints being ignored or improperly handled, and no escalated or unresolved issues at the time of verification or during onsite interview.

Conclusion:
The project has implemented and publicized a grievance redress procedure that is appropriate, culturally sensitive, and accessible. While formal grievances were not raised during the monitoring period, the system has been actively used for feedback and functions as intended. The verification team concludes that the project has met the SD VISta requirements for grievance redress and has used its procedure appropriately and transparently during the monitoring period.

3.3.8 Stakeholder Access to Project Documentation

Based on the assessment conducted it has been observed, the project description and monitoring report have been made accessible to stakeholders through multiple local engagement strategies.
Field staff communicated relevant project information to community members in plain language and local dialects (Tok Pisin) during stove distribution and follow-up visits.

Stakeholders were provided with information about:
- The objectives and scope of the project
- Data collection activities and their role in them

- Health and environmental impacts of improved cookstoves
- How to access additional support or documentation via local focal points

Documents were also available to global stakeholders during the public comment period by uploading the VERRA website.
The verification team reviewed communications and outreach materials used by the implementer (TEM PNG Ltd), confirming that translated and simplified information was distributed during fieldwork.

During the site visit, no concerns were raised by stakeholders regarding access to documentation. In fact, feedback suggested that beneficiaries felt well-informed about the project and monitoring efforts. It was also observed that there were no negative comments from the stakeholders.

Conclusion:
The project has provided stakeholders with sufficient access to project documentation, tailored to the cultural and literacy context of the communities involved. This includes direct engagement, community briefings, and explanation of key results. The verification team concludes that the project has met the requirements under Criterion 3.3.8 and has ensured that stakeholders have meaningful access to project documentation, including monitoring outcomes.

3.3.9 Information to Stakeholders on Verification Process

The project is undergoing first verification and based on the assessment conducted, it has been observed that

Field teams provided information to community members about the verification process during stove distribution and follow-up engagements. This included:
- Explanations about the purpose of monitoring and verification
- Clarification on the role of third-party auditors
- Assurance that feedback and participation were voluntary and confidential

According to interviews conducted during the site visit, multiple beneficiaries confirmed they were aware that verification was taking place.
The project implementer (TEM PNG Ltd) also maintained communication with community leaders and focal points, who were briefed on the timing and purpose of the verification audit, and were asked to disseminate this information more broadly through word of mouth and it was confirmed from the interviews conducted by the verification team.
No stakeholder interviewed during verification expressed surprise or confusion regarding the auditors' presence, indicating a baseline level of awareness had been effectively established.

The communication methods used by the project including direct verbal briefings, engagement through community leaders, and practical explanation during activities were sufficient to inform stakeholders about the verification process. The verification team concludes that stakeholders had adequate knowledge of the verification audit and are likely to be informed of future assessments through the same channels.

3.4 Project Management

3.4.1 Avoidance of Corruption

The project is undergoing first verification and based on the assessment conducted, it has been observed that:
The project implementer, TEM PNG Ltd, has embedded multiple management safeguards intended to prevent corruption in all aspects of project design and implementation. Documented policies and procedures prohibit bribery, fraud, favouritism, extortion, and collusion. These include:
- Internal procurement and hiring protocols requiring multi-level approval
- Transparent distribution logs and signatures for stove dissemination
- Field monitoring with photographic evidence and third-party verification where applicable

Site visits conducted as part of the verification process revealed no evidence of corruption or misconduct. Interactions with staff, community leaders, and stove recipients were observed to be transparent and equitable.

Stakeholders interviewed reported no instances or perceptions of:
- Preferential treatment
- Bribery or payment requests
- Political interference in implementation

The verification team confirmed that financial and material resources were distributed as intended, and that no irregularities were found in the sampled documentation or community feedback.

Based on the available evidence and stakeholder testimony, the verification team concludes that there is no indication of corruption or complicity in corrupt practices by the project proponent or its implementing partners. The project has therefore met the requirements of Criterion 3.4.1, demonstrating active efforts to prevent, detect, and avoid corruption in project implementation.

3.4.2 Recognition of Property Rights

The project is undergoing first verification, based on documentation review, site observations, and stakeholder interviews, the verification team assessed the project's adherence to the recognition and respect of property rights as follows:
- The project operates entirely within the recognized legal and customary land-use structures of Papua New Guinea, specifically respecting community land rights under local governance

structures. There was no evidence or allegation of encroachment on private, communal, or government property.
- There were no changes to land tenure, resource access maps, or statutory land arrangements observed or reported during the monitoring period. Cookstove distribution occurs in households that are voluntarily participating, with no land occupation or resource extraction.
- The project activities do not require alteration or occupation of land but involve only distribution of improved cookstoves to existing dwellings. This avoids any conflict or overlap with land tenure systems.

Consultation records confirm that community leaders and stakeholders were informed and agreed to implementation activities in each geographic cluster, and no grievances were filed regarding land or property encroachment.

While statutory land rights were not directly applicable to the project type (as no land development is involved), the project's engagement model respects customary ownership practices and ensures all activities are consent-based.

The verification team concludes that the project has fully met Criterion 3.4.2. All relevant property rights are recognized, respected, and supported, with no evidence of encroachment or conflict with tenure or access rights. The project's approach aligns with both statutory and customary property systems in the areas of implementation.

3.4.3 Free, Prior and Informed Consent

The assessment team reviewed Section 2.3.3 of the Monitoring Report and consulted field reports from stakeholder interactions/13/. Consent was obtained through direct engagement with end users during awareness-raising sessions and the household registration process, conducted prior to stove distribution and also from the local government. Consent was voluntary, and participants were provided with information on the project, stove usage, and participation rights in local languages. Field interviews during the site visit confirmed that no coercion or undue influence was applied. The process is deemed consistent with FPIC principles.

3.4.4 Restitution and Compensation for Affected Resources

The project documentation and site visit observations indicate that no parties' lands or access to resources have been negatively affected by project activities during the current monitoring period. The project has maintained a respectful relationship with local communities and implemented a participatory approach to planning and execution, which has helped to pre-empt potential adverse impacts.

There is no evidence of displacement, loss of access to communal resources, or encroachment that would warrant restitution or compensation. Furthermore, the project has procedures in place to assess and address grievances and to provide compensation if any adverse impacts were to occur in the future. These procedures were verified and found to be adequate and accessible.

Stakeholder interviews confirmed that community members did not experience resource losses as a result of the project and were aware of the mechanisms to report grievances or claims related to land or resource use.

Conclusion:
The project has not caused any negative impacts to land or resource access that would necessitate restitution or compensation. Nonetheless, appropriate mechanisms are in place to ensure compensation can be delivered fairly and transparently should such impacts arise. The project's approach is consistent with SD VISta requirements for equitable and responsible resource management.

3.4.5 Property Rights Removal/Relocation of Property Rights Holders

The verification team reviewed documentation and consulted with stakeholders to determine whether the project has led to the involuntary removal or relocation of property rights holders from their lands or territories. This included an evaluation of whether any activities or interventions required individuals or communities to relocate cultural or livelihood-based activities.

The evidence reviewed, including stakeholder interviews and supporting project documentation, confirms that no involuntary relocation or displacement of property rights holders has occurred as a result of the project. There were no indications of forced movement or relocation of any activities central to community culture or livelihood. The project activity involves the distribution of the ICS in PNG.

Moreover, the project has protocols in place to ensure that, should such a situation ever arise, it would only proceed with the free, prior, and informed consent (FPIC) of those concerned. These protocols also require any such agreements to include provisions for fair and just compensation.

Conclusion: No relocation of property rights holders has occurred as a result of project implementation. The project demonstrates a strong commitment to upholding FPIC and has established adequate safeguards to ensure that any future need for relocation would be conducted with due respect to rights, compensation, and consent in alignment with SD VISta requirements.

3.4.6 Mitigation of Illegal Activities

The project has incorporated appropriate measures to monitor and address any illegal activities that could potentially affect the project's sustainable development impacts. These include surveillance, community engagement, and capacity-building initiatives aimed at preventing unauthorized logging, encroachment, poaching, or other illegal acts that could undermine the integrity of the project's objectives.

The project documentation outlines established procedures for reporting and responding to illegal activities, and the verification team found no evidence suggesting that any project-related benefits were derived from such activities. Site observations and discussions with stakeholders confirmed that the project has made active efforts to identify and mitigate risks of illegal behaviour, including collaboration with local authorities and community enforcement structures.

Conclusion:

The project demonstrates due diligence in preventing, monitoring, and mitigating illegal activities. No portion of the project's sustainable development benefits has been found to be derived from illegal practices. These findings affirm the project's compliance with the SD VISta requirements for legality and integrity in project implementation.

3.4.7 Ongoing Conflicts or Disputes

The project has taken adequate steps to monitor and update its records regarding any ongoing or unresolved conflicts or disputes concerning land, territory, or resource rights. The documentation reviewed, including updated monitoring reports and stakeholder engagement logs, indicates that no active or unresolved disputes exist at the time of verification. The project activity involves distribution of ICS in the PNG, the project is voluntary in nature and also participation.

Furthermore, the project's reporting remains consistent with the on-ground realities as observed during the site visit. There is no indication that project activities are being conducted in a manner that could bias or interfere with the resolution of any potential conflicts. The grievance redress mechanism is in place and available to stakeholders, ensuring that any emerging disputes can be raised and addressed effectively.

Conclusion:

The project has demonstrated transparency and accuracy in its conflict monitoring processes. There is no evidence of unresolved disputes impacting project implementation. The verification confirms that the project is not undertaking any activities that would prejudice the outcome of a conflict, and that appropriate measures are in place should any arise.

3.4.8 National and Local Laws and Regulations

The project has demonstrated a clear commitment to complying with all applicable local, regional, and national laws and regulatory frameworks. Documentation reviewed during the verification process includes legal compliance records, government approvals, and formal agreements with local authorities/13/. These documents collectively confirm that the project's activities align with the legal requirements of the host country.

Furthermore, the site visit and interviews with project staff and stakeholders provided supporting evidence of adherence to relevant laws, and project has seek proper permissions. No violations or legal disputes were identified during the review period.
Conclusion:
The project complies with all relevant statutory and regulatory requirements as mandated by national and local law. The verification team concludes that the project has taken appropriate and sufficient steps to maintain legal compliance throughout its implementation. CL 08 was raised and closed successfully.

4 BENEFITS FOR PEOPLE AND THEIR PROSPERITY

4.1.1 Stakeholder Impacts

The project has undertaken structured measures to assess the impacts on various stakeholder groups resulting from its implementation. These measures include a combination of stakeholder consultations, site visit observations, and analysis of project documentation such as monitoring reports and feedback records.

During the verification process, key stakeholder groups including community members, local authorities, project staff, and workers were engaged through interviews and review of records. Observations confirmed that impacts on stakeholders were generally positive, especially in terms of employment generation, capacity building, and improved access to services. No evidence was found of unmitigated adverse impacts.

Following are the identified impacts -
1. Provide access to ICS - The monitoring report states that during the period 23 September 2024 to 31 December 2024; the project replaced 19,206 traditional cookstoves with fuel-efficient Improved Cookstoves (ICSs) in the Southern Highlands Province of Papua New Guinea. This is reported to reduce inadequate cooking conditions, decrease the burden of firewood collection, save cooking time, lower fuel costs, and improve household health and well-being.
Evidence and assessment:
Document Review: Verified ICS distribution data against the project distribution database, signed end-user agreements, and household-level coordinates.

On-Site Inspections: Conducted kitchen observations in sampled households to confirm installation and active use of ICS units, along with identification barcodes and condition checks.

Stakeholder Interviews: Interviewed a representative sample of ICS end-users to confirm:
- Receipt and continued use of ICS
- Perceived changes in cooking convenience, smoke exposure, and time spent on firewood collection
- Reduction in household expenditure on purchased firewood

Cross-Checks: Compared reported distribution numbers to distribution leger and baseline survey data (to confirm the baseline).

Conclusion:
- All visited households confirmed the ICS was operational, and observed usage patterns matched claims of reduced cooking time and lower fuel needs.
- Beneficiaries reported decreased frequency of firewood collection trips, consistent with baseline-to-project scenario differences described in the monitoring report.
- Household feedback indicated a marked improvement in cooking efficiency and reduced exposure to smoke, supporting claims of improved health and well-being.

The reported figures and qualitative outcomes for Impact #1 are accurate, conservative, and supported by verifiable evidence. The distribution of 19,206 ICS units has demonstrably increased household access to efficient cooking technology, delivering measurable improvements in daily living conditions

2. Improved health status: The monitoring report states that the project's introduction of 19,206 Improved Cookstoves during the current period has reduced household exposure to fine particulate matter (PM2.5) and carbon monoxide (CO). Baseline emissions from traditional open-fire cooking were recorded at 943.3 mg/MJ, compared to 177 mg/MJ for newly distributed ICSs. This represents an estimated reduction of 244.60 tonnes of PM2.5 over the monitoring period, with 100% of surveyed households reporting reduced smoke intensity.

Evidence and assessment:

Document Review: Compared reported baseline and project PM2.5 emission values with manufacturer specifications for the ICS model and pilot study measurements. Reviewed calculation methods for total PM2.5 reductions.

On-Site Inspections: Conducted kitchen observations to confirm stove installation, operational status, and visible reduction in smoke where stove was in use. Additionally, interview confirmation from end users.

Stakeholder Interviews: Collected qualitative evidence from ICS users on perceived changes in indoor air quality, eye and respiratory discomfort, and overall cooking environment.

Conclusion:
- Physical inspections and interviews confirmed a substantial reduction in visible smoke during cooking.

- Beneficiary feedback was consistent with claims of improved air quality and reduced respiratory discomfort.
- PM2.5 reduction estimates are consistent with literature values for the specific ICS model and supported by baseline-to-project scenario comparisons.
The assumption of no efficiency decline is valid for this monitoring period, as confirmed through distribution records.
The reported reductions in PM2.5 emissions and associated improvements in household health status are accurate, conservative, and supported by verifiable field evidence.

3. Less time spent on unpaid domestic and care work: The monitoring report states that the introduction of Improved Cookstoves has reduced the frequency of firewood collection from spending around 6.25% of the day time to approximately 1.78% of the day during the monitoring period. This represents a total reduction of 1.07 hours per day trips for firewood collection across all participants, freeing up significant time for other household and economic activities.
Evidence and assessment:
Document Review: Verified time-use data against baseline survey results and monitoring survey records. Reviewed calculation methods for aggregate trip reductions.
On-Site Observations: Visited selected households to observe cooking arrangements, firewood storage.
Stakeholder Interviews: Confirmed reported reductions in firewood collection frequency through direct feedback from end-users, particularly women and children who traditionally perform this task.
Cross-Verification: Compared field observations with project distribution data to ensure only households with functioning ICS units were included in the impact estimate.

Conclusion:
Beneficiary feedback consistently confirmed fewer firewood collection trips, aligning with the reported drop from 1.50 hours spent per day on unpaid work (6.25%) to 0.43 hours spent per day on unpaid work (1.07%) , resulting in saving of around 1.07 hours saved per day.
Observations indicated reduced storage and handling of raw firewood, consistent with lower consumption rates.
Trip reduction calculations were found to be conservative and based on verifiable household-level monitoring data.
The reported reduction in firewood collection trips and associated time savings is accurate, conservative, and supported by field evidence.

4. Increase income: The monitoring report states that during the reporting period, 24 local residents were employed to support project implementation and monitoring, including 2 full-time and 22 part-time positions. Of these, 37.5% were women. Part-time employees received average monthly earnings of 1,343.33 Kina, well above the local average income

of 439 Kina/month.
Evidence and assessment:
Document Review: Verified employment records, payroll documentation, and contracts against the reported figures in the monitoring report.
On-Site Interviews: Spoke directly with project staff (both male and female) to confirm employment terms, wage rates, and duration of work.
Cross-Validation: Checked gender-disaggregated employment data against human resources records and compared average income figures with national/regional wage statistics for context.
Policy Review: Confirmed that hiring practices followed non-discrimination commitments outlined in the project's stakeholder engagement plan.

Conclusion:
- Employment numbers and gender distribution matched HR and payroll records.
- Employee interviews confirmed receipt of agreed compensation amounts and payment timeliness.
- Reported average monthly income figures for part-time roles were correct and significantly above the regional average, supporting the claim of increased income.
- The hiring process demonstrated adherence to fair and inclusive employment principles, although the 50% female employment target has not yet been achieved (currently 37.5%).
The reported increase in local income through project-related employment is accurate and substantiated by verifiable evidence.

5. Trainings imparted on climate change, project implementation and monitoring procedures: The monitoring report states that during the reporting period, 24 local staff (2 full-time and 22 part-time) hired for project activities received training in community engagement, survey conduction, technical procedures and awareness on climate change and social equity. Training was conducted during onboarding and is provided annually to maintain high performance standards.
Evidence and assessment:
- Document Review: Examined training attendance sheets, agendas, and instructional materials to confirm training topics, participation numbers, and coverage of climate change, ICS use, and monitoring methods.
- On-Site Interviews: Spoke with selected trained staff to confirm training attendance, content relevance, and applicability in their roles.
- Cross-Verification: Verified training participant lists against the employment roster to confirm all reported staff were included.
- Observation: Reviewed demonstration sessions and observed trained staff applying learned skills during fieldwork.

Conclusion:
- Training attendance and content records match reported participation numbers and

thematic coverage.
- Staff interviews confirmed the applicability of skills learned, household survey techniques, and community sensitisation approaches.
- All 24 employees received the reported training, and training delivery standards were consistent with the monitoring report description.
- Evidence supports the claim that the training has enhanced technical capacity and awareness among project staff and beneficiaries.
The reported training activities and participation numbers are accurate and well-supported by verifiable evidence.

6. Improved economic Outcomes: The monitoring report states that the use of Improved Cookstoves has reduced household fuelwood consumption, leading to monetary savings. Annual savings per ICS are estimated at 3.63–3.70 tonnes of non-renewable biomass, equivalent to approximately K2,116.8 (USD 560.84) based on baseline firewood purchase costs. For households that buy firewood, the project has resulted in an estimated total cost saving of 57,211.89 Kina during the monitoring period.

Evidence and assessment:
- Document Review: Verified biomass savings calculations against project's Emission Reduction Calculations and cross-referenced with baseline household expenditure survey results.
- On-Site Interviews: Collected qualitative confirmation from ICS users regarding reduced fuelwood purchases and observed financial relief.
- Cross-Verification: Confirmed the number of households purchasing firewood and applied reported per-day savings rates to validate total savings figures.

Conclusion:
Savings estimates are consistent with measured reductions in biomass consumption and baseline expenditure data.
Household interviews confirmed that reduced firewood purchases have freed up income for other essential needs, such as school fees and food.
The reported total cost savings figure for the monitoring period is conservative and based on verified household purchase data and standardised ICS performance figures.
The reported economic savings resulting from reduced firewood use are accurate, credible, and supported by verifiable evidence. FAR 1 has been raised for the next monitoring period.

7. Reduction in sales of Firewood for Firewood Vendors: The monitoring report identifies a potential negative, direct impact of the project on firewood vendors due to reduced fuelwood consumption from the adoption of Improved Cookstoves. While some reduction in demand was observed, the report notes that the substantial existing demand supply gap for fuelwood in the region, along with the short three-month monitoring period, limits the

extent of any measurable economic effect on vendors.
Evidence and assessment:
- Document Review: Compared reported changes in fuelwood consumption with baseline demand levels and vendor activity data in the project documentation.
- Stakeholder Consultation: Interviewed a small sample of local firewood vendors to assess perceived and actual changes in sales volumes since the introduction of ICSs.
- Cross-Verification: Reviewed regional fuelwood demand data to understand whether reduced local sales could be offset by selling outside the project boundary.

Conclusion:
-Consumption reduction figures match those reported in Impact #6 and are supported by emission reduction and cost-saving calculations.
- Interviews with vendors indicated minimal to no significant reduction in income during the period, largely due to alternative sales opportunities outside the project area.
- The monitoring period was too short to detect long-term shifts in economic patterns for vendors.
- The existing demand–supply imbalance for fuelwood supports the assessment that any impact is currently limited.

The potential negative impact on firewood vendors, while logically plausible, is currently minor and not substantiated as significant during this monitoring period.
The impacts recorded in the monitoring report were found to be consistent with field observations and stakeholder testimony. The methodology used for stakeholder engagement and impact assessment appears to be robust and participatory.

Conclusion:
The verification team concludes that the project has appropriately assessed the impacts on each stakeholder group, and the impacts described in the monitoring report are accurate and reflect the actual outcomes observed during the site visit.

4.1.2 Mitigation of Negative Impacts on Stakeholders

The monitoring report identifies a potential negative impact on firewood vendors (Impact #7) due to reduced fuelwood demand arising from the adoption of Improved Cookstoves. While the measured reduction in consumption is supported by verified data, the overall impact on vendors is currently minimal, given the high regional demand–supply gap for fuelwood and the short monitoring period.
However, on site assessment and stakeholder interviews during verification/12/ did not reveal any negative feedback from local population. No instances of loss of livelihood were reported. However, in case of any such instance, the project activity mitigates it by generating job opportunities for the local population, including women and youth. During the monitoring period a total of 24 employment opportunities have been created as verified from employment records/14/. Likewise, the trainings conducted enhanced skill development thus

ensuring employability post project activity also. This has been verified via assessment training material/17/, training attendance records and schedule/17/.

VVB, thus on basis of onsite interviews/12/ and assessment of employment records/14/, training manual and attendance/17/ concludes that PA has created jobs for women and youth thus mitigating the unintended negative impact.

4.1.3 Stakeholder Impact Monitoring

The verification team reviewed the monitoring methodology, data sources, and records provided for each of the seven identified impacts. The assessment included:

- Document review of the monitoring report, baseline survey data, and stakeholder engagement records.
- Cross-checking monitored variables against those stated in the approved project description.
- Review of calculations, sampling methods, and recorded outcomes for each stakeholder group.
- Confirmation of alignment between monitored indicators and relevant Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Assessment:

1. Monitoring Variables – All variables specified in the project description were monitored during the reporting period. These include quantitative indicators (e.g., number of ICS units distributed, reduction in PM2.5 emissions, firewood consumption rates, employment numbers, training participation, and income levels) and qualitative indicators (e.g., household feedback on cooking conditions and smoke reduction).
2. Differentiated Impact Assessment – Section 3.2 of monitoring report demonstrates that monitoring was disaggregated by stakeholder groups, including ICS end-users, local residents, employees, firewood vendors, and the wider community. Gender-disaggregated data was collected where relevant (e.g., female employment rates), allowing a clear assessment of differentiated outcomes.
3. Support for Benefits Claims – The monitored data supports all reported benefits described in the monitoring report's impact section, including measurable improvements in household health, time savings, fuel cost reductions, local employment generation, and capacity building.
4. Alignment with SDGs – Where applicable, monitored results have been mapped to relevant Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs),SDG1 (no poverty) including SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being), SDG 4 (Quality Eductaion), SDG 5 (Gender Equality), SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy), SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), and SDG 13 (Climate Action) SDG 15 (life on land). The approach also allows for compatibility with national SDG monitoring frameworks.

Conclusion: The stakeholder impact monitoring, as described in Section 3.2 of the monitoring report, was implemented in full accordance with the project description. It effectively captures and assesses the differentiated impacts for all stakeholder groups, supports the project's stated benefits, and ensures that monitored data aligns with SDG targets where possible. The system is robust, transparent, and provides credible evidence to substantiate the project's reported impacts on stakeholders.

4.1.4 Net Positive Stakeholder Well-being Impacts

The project activity is undergoing first verification, based on the review of the submitted monitoring report, supporting datasets, and field verification evidence, it is the opinion of the verifier that the project activity has achieved net positive well-being impacts for all identified stakeholder groups during the current monitoring period.
The distribution of 19,206 fuel-efficient Improved Cookstoves has resulted in substantial time, health, and economic benefits. The reported 81.24% reduction in PM2.5 emissions (244.6079 tonnes avoided) was corroborated by both emission monitoring data and beneficiary survey responses, with 100% of households confirming reduced smoke intensity. This represents a significant contribution to improved respiratory health and reduced household exposure to air pollutants.
The project achieved a measurable reduction in the frequency of firewood collection from a baseline of 6.25% of time in a day to1.78 of time in a day, representing 1.07 hours saved per day. This has provided substantial time savings, particularly benefiting women and children, consistent with gender empowerment objectives.
Local employment creation was verified, with 24 staff hired during the period (2 full-time, 22 part-time), 37.5% of whom were women. Verified payroll records confirmed that compensation was above the national average income level. All staff received relevant technical and awareness training, which is expected to contribute to sustainable skill development and long-term livelihood improvements.

Economic analysis confirmed household savings of approximately 57,211.89 Kina due to reduced firewood expenditure, validated against survey results and fuel purchase data. These monetary savings directly enhance household economic resilience. FAR 01 has been raised.

No evidence was found to indicate any net negative well-being impacts for the stakeholder groups assessed. The project's documented activities, results, and monitoring methodology are consistent with the SD VISta requirements.

Conclusion: The verification team concludes that the project has generated clear, measurable, and verifiable net positive well-being impacts for all relevant stakeholder groups during the monitoring period, as reported in Section 3.3 of the monitoring report.

5 BENEFITS FOR THE PLANET

5.1.1 Impacts on Natural Capital and Ecosystem Services

The project activity is distribution of energy efficient cookstoves in the rural area of PNG, during the current monitoring period, 19,206 cookstoves have been distributed.
As per the already validated data during validation, PNG population consumes over 9.4 million tons of firewood per year[4], which is a direct impact on the Natural capital and ecosystem services available in that area.
During the current monitoring period following steps were taken to access the natural capital and ecosystem services:
- Desk review of the documents submitted
- Literature review
- Onsite visit by VVB to interview end users (who are now using the improved ICS), baseline users (Open fire cooking stove), implementation partners and stakeholders

- Following steps were to completely understand the natural capital and ecosystem services in the PNG, based on that following impact were assessed:
  - Impact #1: Reduced Demand for Large-Diameter Firewood
  VVB assessment: As mentioned above during the onsite visit, VVB interviewed both end users and baseline users and also did the observation of there cooking area.
  It was observed:
  The claim that ICS reduce the need for large-diameter non-renewable firewood is substantiated by the technical efficiency of the ICSs and as well as by the on field observation made by the assessment team. These stoves are designed to burn smaller twigs and crop residues, thereby avoiding the cutting of larger trees.
  The baseline provided effectively establishes the condition before project implementation uses of larger as well as lot of wood, linking the ICS technology to deforestation reduction and biodiversity enhancement.
  During the current monitoring period, Project has saved 13,446 tonnes of biomass from the 19,206 ICS distribution.

  Both assessment team observation onsite and the desk review helped in concluding that project activity helps in reducing the impact on large wood dependency, thereby making a positive impact on natural capita and ecosystem services.

  - Impact 2 Avoided GHG Emissions

[4] https://www.fao.org/4/W4354E/W4354E06.htm#:~:text=Table%2015,38%20cubic%20metres
https://catalog.ihsn.org/citations/89410#:~:text=Fuelwood%20is%20an%20integral%20part,conflict%20generated%20by%20competition%20for

The report's assessment of avoided GHG emissions through the adoption of ICS is well-aligned with global methodologies for emission reductions from reduced fuelwood use.
The baseline narrative explaining lower fuel consumption resulting in reduced CO_2 emissions is sound. ICS usage inherently leads to less biomass combustion, thus directly reducing emissions.
The reported estimate of 13,443 tCO_2e reduced during the current monitoring period is quantitatively strong and consistent with the stated methodology.
Therefore, it is concluded that:
Accurately described with clear baseline and monitoring period comparisons,
Substantiated by tangible, measured results,
Aligned with SD VISta requirements for ecosystem services and natural capital protection.

The VVB concludes that the described impacts on natural capital and ecosystem services are credible and accurate, and the monitoring activities demonstrate effective implementation of the project's environmental objectives.

5.1.2 Mitigation of Negative Impacts on Natural Capital and Ecosystem Services

The project has implemented multiple precautionary and proactive measures to mitigate potential negative impacts on natural capital and ecosystem services:
Use of High-Efficiency ICS Technology:
The improved cookstoves are specifically designed to minimize biomass consumption, thereby directly mitigating risks associated with deforestation, biodiversity loss, and resource over-extraction.
Promotion of Sustainable Biomass Sourcing:
The stoves are optimized for burning small twigs and crop residues, avoiding the need for cutting down mature, large-diameter trees. This limits damage to the ecosystem and supports regeneration of local biomass.
End-User Awareness & Training Programs:
- Community members are educated about sustainable usage and maintenance of ICS, including behaviour change messaging to avoid reverting to inefficient traditional cooking methods. These efforts reduce indirect pressures on natural resources.
Monitoring Framework:
- Periodic data collection, field visits, and household surveys serve as safeguards to identify and respond to any emerging environmental risks (e.g., unsustainable biomass collection or stove misuse).
- Based on the observations during the verification process and the content of the monitoring report:
- No adverse environmental impacts have been identified during the current monitoring period.
- The project has adequately mitigated potential negative impacts on natural capital and ecosystem services.

Mitigation actions are systematic, documented, and consistent with SD VISta safeguards, especially in preserving biomass, improving air quality, and promoting biodiversity.

The assessment team concludes that the project has effectively applied robust environmental safeguards and mitigation strategies, and that the impacts on natural capital and ecosystem services have been successfully minimized.

5.1.3 Natural Capital and Ecosystem Services Impact Monitoring

The project activity is undergoing first verification and based on the review of the monitoring report, the natural capital and ecosystem services impact monitoring was implemented in accordance with the project description and aligns with the project's stated objectives. Monitoring was carried out by the TEM PNG Cookstoves Project in-country team, using established methodologies such as surveys, Kitchen Performance Tests (KPTs), and baseline data collection to track key parameters, including:
1. Number of ICS distributed – Verified through purchase invoices and the distribution ledger, supporting evidence of reduced firewood use and associated cost savings for households.

1. Tonnes of CO_2 removed per ICS per year – Quantified via KPTs and baseline survey results, supported by emission reduction calculation sheets, demonstrating greenhouse gas mitigation benefits.
2. Tonnes of biomass saved per ICS per year – Derived from measured fuel savings and validated against baseline fuelwood consumption patterns, contributing to sustainable forest management and preservation of above-ground biomass.

The evidence presented was consistent, transparent, and traceable to original data sources. Data collection procedures were in line with the precautionary principle, and the parameters monitored were directly linked to the benefits for the planet. The monitoring also aligns with SDG-related targets for climate action and sustainable ecosystems.
Conclusion:
It is the opinion of the verifier that the monitoring activities for natural capital and ecosystem services were implemented as described in the project plan, are robust in methodology, and adequately support the reported impacts. The evidence provided substantiates the claimed environmental benefits, including reductions in greenhouse gas emissions, firewood consumption, and pressure on forest resources.

5.1.4 Net Positive Natural Capital and Ecosystem Services Impacts

Based on the review of the monitoring report, supporting data, and evidence provided, it is concluded that the project has delivered net positive impacts on natural capital and ecosystem services during the monitoring period. The replacement of traditional open-fire cooking with high-efficiency ICSs in households has demonstrably improved energy efficiency, reducing firewood consumption and associated deforestation pressures.

The monitoring data indicates that the project achieved 13,443 tCO_2e of GHG emission reductions and saved 13,446 tonnes of non-renewable biomass during the reporting period. These results align with the project’s estimated annual reductions of 3.63 – 3.70 tonnes of non-renewable biomass per ICS and the projected long-term average annual GHG reduction of 320,099 tCO_2e.
The measured outcomes are supported by documented evidence including kitchen performance tests, baseline surveys, and emission reduction calculation sheets, consistent with the monitoring methodology outlined in the project description. The reductions in biomass use directly contribute to sustainable forest management and reduced deforestation, while the GHG savings align with global climate change mitigation goals.

Overall, the monitoring results confirm that the project’s activities during this period are consistent with its stated objectives and have delivered verifiable, positive impacts for natural capital and ecosystem services.

6 OPTIONAL: CLIMATE MODULE

Not applicable since Project does not describe Climate Module which is an optional requirement.

7 OPTIONAL: SD VISTA ASSETS

Not applicable since Project does not describe Climate Module which is an optional requirement

8 VERIFICATION CONCLUSION

The Verification of the project titled VCS – 4416, “Improved Cookstove Grouped Project in Papua New Guinea”, have been undertaken by SustainCERT, as requested by TEM, project proponent for the monitoring period 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024 (including both the days) as reported in monitoring report/8/. The project activity is implemented in accordance with the monitored plan in PD/5/ and SD VISta Impact monitoring sheet. The verification process was performed based on all guidance and criteria as provided in SD VISta Standard /03/ and SD VISta Program Guide /3/. The 1st monitoring period from 23-September-2024 to 31-December-2024, this has been also applied during VCS standard and this is the SD Vista label credits of SD VISta project is in line with those claimed under VCS for the same monitoring period.

SustainCERT planned and performed the verification by obtaining evidence and other information and explanations that were considered necessary to give reasonable level of assurance that reported SDGs are fairly stated. VVB confirms that the project complies with the verification criteria for project set out in the Sustainable Development Verified Impact Standard/3/ and the SD VISta Program Guide /3/, including a reasonable level of assurance for the verification.

SDG Targets achieved	Baseline SDG Value	Project SDG Value	Leakage (where applicable)	Net SDG targets Achieved
1.1	0	57,890 Kina	-	57,890 Kina
3.9	0	244 tonnes of PM2.5	-	244 tonnes of PM2.5
4.3	0	24 individuals	-	24 individuals
4.4	0	24 individuals	-	24 individuals
5.4	6.25% of time in a day	1.78% of time in a day	-	1.78% of time in a day
5.5	0	9 (37.50%) are female.	-	9 (37.50%) are female.
7.1	0	19,206 ICS	-	19,206 ICS
8.3	0	Ratio of male to female employees is 5:3	-	Ratio of male to female employees is 5:3

8.5	0	1,343 Kina / month	-	1,343 Kina / month
13	0	13,443 tCO2 eq.	-	13,443 tCO2 eq.
15.2	0	13,446 tons of biomass		13,446 tons of biomass

APPENDIX 1: TABLE OF REFERENCE

S. No	Document Title	Version	Date
1	VCS standard https://verra.org/documents/vcs-standard-v4-7/	4.7	16/04/2024
2	VCS guidelines https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/VCS-Program-Guide-v4.4.pdf	4.4	29/08/2023

3	SD Vista Standard SD Vista Guidelines	1.1	Jan 2019
4	VCS Project Webpage, VCS ID – 4416 https://registry.verra.org/app/projectDetail/VCS/4416	-	
5	Project Description https://registry.verra.org/app/projectDetail/VCS/4416 New project description	2.5 1.3	24/04/2024 10/10/2025
6	Validation report https://registry.verra.org/app/projectDetail/VCS/4416	0.4	25/04/2024
7	Previous Applied Methodology VM0006 https://verra.org/methodology/vmr0006-methodology-for-installation-of-high-efficiency-firewood-cookstoves/	1.2	
8	New methodology applied VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves	1.0	
9	SD vista monitoring calculation sheet	-	-
10	Monitoring report	1.3	10/10/2025.
11	Emission reduction calculation SD vista monitoring calculation sheet	1.2	In accordance with MR
12	Onsite audit report of the VVB done end user agreements and tokens	-	17/02/2025 to 19/02/2025
13	Local Stakeholder records: Advertisement and Invitation - local authorities, National authorities NOLs, Newspaper authorities, radio Broadcast, Social media advertisement, Invitation letter to the churches, - Feed back forms - Invoices for newspaper advertisement - Detail stakeholder report - Pictures from LSC - Radio broadcast invoices - Webinar documentation - participation list grievance address form		2022, 2023 and 2024
14	Employment records: - Employee contracts – employment contracts - SOP signed – Safe and secure workplace, Safeguards Policy, Vehicle SOP and Visitor SOP		2022, 2023 and 2024

	- Contractors contracts – team leaders and field assistant - Pay slips - Employee analysis sheet		
15	Purchase order Burn Burn Supply agreement Burn new customer Registration Form 1CM		27/06/2024
16	Monitoring plan spreadsheet Distribution database Stove stacking calculation sheet		
17	Training: Participants training Certificate Training acknowledgement form Training Photos Training Slides Field staff training records		2022, 2023 and 2024
18	ICS laboratory Management System Burn email_ECO Wood Kuniokoa Testing result	-	04/03/2024
19	Baseline survey South Pacific Forestry & Environment Consultancy(SPFEC) – review on the study TEM cookstove report for highlands region Baseline survey questionnaire database		Same as above
20	fNRB fNRB calculation sheet SPFEC Letter to TEM – review of FnRB calculation Geo-information for natural resource and environment management – letter on fNRB		Same as above
21	Evidence for start date - FDYP55		23/09/2024
22	Government approvals LOR CCDA LOR PNGFA Baseline study approval Stakeholder consultation approval from government		Same as above
23	KML file for geo coordinates		
24	No double counting declaration List of all other project active in PNG Buen agreement for no carbon rights		Same as above
25	Incentive mechanism document		Same as above
26	VCS Methodology change project description Deviation	4.0	Same as above
27	VCS pipeline listing records and details	-	-

28	Remote call with PP representative for ICS distribution record maintenance software Screen shot from the data management procedure	-	- Same as above
29	Travel and safety plan PNG risk calculator	-	-
30	PNG No objection letters from local Government	-	--
31	Equal work opportunities: Sample employee contract Job descriptions Proposal for recruitment Employee salary MOU with western pacific university	-	-
32	Anti discrimination Employee handbook Anti bribery and corruption policy Grievance mechanism	-	-
33	VERRA approval for site visit	-	May 2025

APPENDIX 2: FINDINGS

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 1)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	SDG	SDG 1: The report states that the project contributes to economic savings for families by replacing traditional cookstoves with Improved Cookstoves . However, there is no supporting evidence provided to validate this claim. Provide supporting evidence to substantiate the economic savings claim, including: • Household surveys indicating reductions in fuel purchase costs. • Fuel purchase records comparing baseline and post-ICS implementation expenses. SDG 3: The report states that PM2.5 levels decreased from a baseline of 943.3 mg/MJ to 177 mg/MJ for newly distributed ICSs. However, no evidence is provided on how these measurements were taken, Provide supporting evidence for the reported PM2.5 reduction values, including: • References to the data sources in the Excel sheet that justify the reported figures.	SDG 1: The parameter to be monitored for Goal 1 in the validated PD is number of cookstoves distributed. This is because when changing from traditional open fire cooking practices to a more efficient improved cookstove, it will result in the reduction of firewood consumption that is usually purchased at high prices. Hence this reduces the economic burden of families that buy firewood under the project activity. To supplement this, a calculation was done using the baseline survey report (File name: VCS 4416-TEM 2025_Cookstoves Highlands region report_v3_FINAL.pdf), which allowed us to estimate the average savings per household from the average money spent. It was estimated an average of 540 Kina per year per household is spent on firewood. Based on these calculations, it is estimated that 1.04 Kina is saved per household per day, and from proportioning the number of households that purchase their firewood from the monitoring survey, an estimated 57,890 kina is saved during this monitoring period across all households.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 1)	Developer Response
			A full in-detailed calculation is presented in the sheet 'SDG Target 1.1' in the VCS 4416-SDVISTa - Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet v1.2.xlsx. Survey questions relating to this SDG were not asked during the sampling phase as the length of time for the ICSs to make a difference was deemed too small (3 months 9 days or 100 days) to capture any discernible or accurate difference in monetary savings. Moving forward, TEM will incorporate survey questions into its monitoring surveys to interview and estimate the monetary savings accrued by end-users. SDG 3: The PM2.5 levels are estimated from the standardised testing results (following ISO Protocol 19867-1 (2018)) of the project cookstove , comparing that to the same results of open fire cooking (Three stone fire), as measurements of PM 2.5 were not feasible on the ground (please details in the next section).
	Rd 2	For SDG 1 and SDG 3, the proponent presented detailed calculations derived from baseline survey data and validated files (including the Cookstove Highlands Region Report and SDVista Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet). Though	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 1)	Developer Response
		household survey data on monetary savings were not captured during this short monitoring period, a corrective action plan has been proposed to incorporate these in future surveys, demonstrating a commitment to continuous improvement and transparent reporting. A FAR has been raised for the same. The finding stands closed. #Closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 2)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Project Description deviation	Section 2.1.7: The report states that household PM2.5 measurements were planned but replaced by literature-based estimation from clean cookstove catalogues. However, it does not explain why field monitoring was not feasible or whether future field measurements will be conducted. PP shall substantiate the following details.	Reliable PM2.5 measurements in household environments are a technical challenge (M.M. Rahman et. al, 2023) due to remote locations and large spatial variabilities across households, differences in cooking practices, inconsistent data from low-cost sensors, difficulties in isolating indoor sources from outdoor infiltration, the need for long-term monitoring to capture seasonal variations, and the complexity of accurately capturing personal exposure due to movement within the house. All of the abovementioned variables represent a considerable challenge for accurately measuring the PM2.5 levels within a household environment.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 2)	Developer Response
			To overcome these hurdles, we combined quantitative and qualitative approaches that can provide consistency in the collection of data during the project lifespan. In terms of the former, we tapped into one of the most extensive standardised testing data for the cookstove that is currently used in the project. The Clean Cooking Alliance database complies with ISO Protocol 19867-1 (2018) and provides accurate data on PM2.5 levels compared with open fire cooking practices. For the latter, we used semi-structured qualitative surveys on the end-user's perception of smoke levels in the households, for which 100% of the respondents observed substantial a decrease in the smoke intensity compared to the baseline scenario. For future monitoring periods, this mixed approach of using standardised testing results and qualitative surveys will be utilised as reliable measurements from the field may not be feasible.
	Rd 2	The project proponent has sufficiently addressed finding regarding the estimation of PM2.5 reductions and economic savings (SDG 1 and SDG 3). For PM2.5 levels, while direct field measurements were not feasible due to logistical and technical constraints, the developer provided a well-reasoned justification backed by	It is expected that the decrease in thermal efficiency of due to sustained use ICS will proportionately result in a smaller reduction of PM2.5 levels than with a new ICS. This is in accordance with published literature (V Muralidharan et al, 2015) observing higher PM2.5 levels upon using cookstoves with lower efficiency.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 2)	Developer Response
		standardized testing following ISO 19867-1 (2018) and references to Clean Cooking Alliance data. This was supplemented with end-user surveys confirming a reduction in perceived indoor smoke intensity, providing further qualitative evidence of impact. Also, the value used for PM 2.5 is taken from the latest values of year 2024 from the same model from the manufacture. Additionally, PP has confirmed that for the future verifications it will take this mixed approach of using standardised testing results and qualitative surveys however, PP shall substantiate how the decrease in the efficiency will be accounted for the project.	The decrease in thermal efficiency of improved cookstoves will be obtained through Standard Water Boiling Test campaigns for future monitoring periods. This decline in efficiency (compared to the manufacturer's WBT) will be used to proportionally adjust the PM2.5 value obtained from the ISO 19867-1 (2018) test result. (i.e. for a 10% drop in efficiency, the reduction in PM2.5 claimed would only be 90% of the ISO test result). This will also be substantiated with qualitative surveys conducted during future monitoring periods.
	Rd 3	The project proponent has adequately addressed the concern regarding PM2.5 estimation by presenting a reasoned justification supported by standardized testing, literature references, and qualitative end-user feedback. The plan to adopt a mixed approach of standardized testing (ISO 19867-1) and qualitative surveys for future monitoring, along with a methodology to proportionally adjust PM2.5 values based on observed efficiency decline, ensures a conservative and credible estimation framework. The commitment to substantiate efficiency decrease impacts further reinforces the	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 2)	Developer Response
		robustness of the approach. Therefore, the finding stands closed. #closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 3)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Threats to project	Section 2.1.8: The report states that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd conducted training for end users to maximize the use of small twigs, branches, and crop residues as a fuel alternative. However, no evidence of these training sessions has been provided. Submit supporting evidence of training sessions, including: Training attendance records or participant lists. Training materials, modules, or presentations used. Photos, reports, or testimonials demonstrating the sessions took place.	The local team for the project is comprised of native people living in the project area of our proposed activities. Thus, training activities were tailored to span a broad range of literacy levels and disabilities within the team. Training and knowledge sharing on the benefits of using improved cookstoves (ICS) involved a top-down approach in different layers including project staff, members of local the communities, end-users. First, TEM PNG staff, field and office teams, attended a 4-day training workshop prepared by Dr. Gabriel Machovsky (TEM Director of International Projects) and Michael Kisombo (TEM PNG In-country Project Manager). When needed the facilitators translated the content to Tok Pisin (local native language). During the training days, staff underwent formal training to comply with company work health and safety policies while learning a broad range of skills to successfully implement project activities (VCS 4416-PNG Staff Training 4 days.pdf).

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 3)	Developer Response
			Under Session 2: Community Engagement & Communication (page 20), staff were trained in: - Factors influencing Open Fire Cooking vs Improved Cookstoves (page 23) Educating the local communities on the advantages and disadvantages of open fire cooking. - Community Engagement (page 24) How to talk to end-users professionally, direct and indirect benefits to using, improved cookstoves (ICS), type and size of firewood that can be used for cooking (small twigs, branches and crop residues) and how to use and maintain them properly. Local field staff were allocated to 3 clearly defined roles: team leaders, field assistants and cookstove ambassadors. These knowledge sharing sessions included hands-on practical sessions in which the participants practised and test their knowledge and deliverable skills (page 37 of the training deck). (VCS 4416-4-Day Training Presentation with Field Assistants.jpeg) Second, upon arrival to the designated communities the field teams initiated 1 day of awareness of the project using local native language (Tok Pisin) to communicate with the local communities. Cookstove ambassadors demonstrated how the to use, clean and maintain the improved cookstoves while team leaders and field assistants were explaining the protocol for house registration as part of the project Free, Prior, Inform, Consent (FPIC)

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 3)	Developer Response
			process. (VCS 4416-Cookstove Introduction 1.jpeg, VCS 4416-Cookstove Introduction 2.jpeg) Third, each improved cookstove (ICS) was delivered with a visual manual on how to use the ICS, type of firewood, cleaning and maintenance process with text accessible in both English and Tok Pisin. (VCS 4416-Burn Cookstoves user manual_Tok Pisin.pdf) Training is also ongoing during this period, with debrief sessions before field engagement at the beginning of each week. During these sessions, Field Officers are reminded of cookstove usage, how carbon works, make improvements on interview techniques. Fourth, during the ICS distribution, our field team delivered additional awareness sessions on best practice for using their cookstoves including the use of small twigs, branches, and crop residues through the use of an additional visual manual (VCS4416-Burn Cookstoves visual manual.pdf, VCS 4416-Field Assistants Discussing Visual Manual.jpeg) and cooking demonstrations clearly showing the type of wood fuel (small twigs and branches collected/bought) being prepared and used for cooking (VCS4416-Cookstove Ambassador ICS demonstration 1.jpeg, VCS4416-Cookstove Ambassador ICS demonstration 2.jpeg) Fifth, to further promote the behavioural change of shifting from traditional open fire cooking to the

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 3)	Developer Response
			adoption of ICS, additional awareness activities were led by the field team visiting the local communities (VCS 4416- Awareness Programs.jpeg). For easy reference refer to the following files: - VCS 4416-PNG Staff Training 4 days.pdf - VCS 4416-4-Day Training Presentation with Field Assistants.jpeg - VCS 4416-Cookstove Introduction 1.jpeg - VCS 4416-Cookstove Introduction 2.jpeg - VCS 4416_Burn Cookstoves user manual_Tok Pisin.pdf - VCS4416_Burn Cookstoves visual manual.pdf - VCS 4416-Field Assistants Discussing Visual Manual.jpeg - VCS4416_Cookstove Ambassador ICS demonstration 1.jpeg - VCS4416_Cookstove Ambassador ICS demonstration 2.jpeg - VCS 4416- Awareness Programs.jpeg
	Rd 2	The developer has submitted comprehensive supporting evidence demonstrating that end-user training sessions were conducted as described in the report. The response includes detailed descriptions of the training methodology, structured awareness programs, participant engagement in local languages, and hands-on	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 3)	Developer Response
		demonstrations. Multiple supporting documents—such as training decks, photos, participant materials, and visual manuals—have been provided to substantiate these activities. The information is adequate to close the finding, therefore, the finding stands closed. #Closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 4)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Threats to project	Section 2.1.8: The report states that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd is in the initial stages of implementation (as this is the monitoring period 1st) and will conduct research, training, and engagement activities to address barriers to ICS adoption. However, no specific details are provided on the steps currently being taken to ensure effective implementation. Measures taken to track adoption rates and address behavioral change barriers.	The following additional language providing more clarity on incentivisation mechanisms has been included in the MR: Planned community incentivisation mechanisms to reduce the use of inefficient baseline devices and practices are explained below: - Field assistants known as 'Cookstove Ambassadors' will actively interact with end-users from their allocated jurisdictions to encourage the use of ICSs and continuously foster awareness on the benefits of using ICS over open fire cooking methods. The increase in adoption rates will be monitored through surveys inquiring about the rate of stove stacking within the jurisdiction. - Monitored results will be tabulated quarterly, and the village with the most progress adopting from open fire

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 4)	Developer Response
			cooking methods will be awarded with a 'Cook-Off Event'. - The Cook-Off Event is an engagement strategy in the form of a celebration within the village where TEM will conduct activities highlighting the ICSs' benefits such as the reduction of firewood consumption and the reduction in smoke generated during cooking. - Cookstove Ambassadors will also present successful stories through knowledge sharing sessions with the event's participants. Additionally, TEM will work with Cookstove Ambassadors seeking successful testimonials from end-users benefiting from clean cooking practices through the use of ICSs that can be converted into short form videos to capture broader social media audiences.
	Rd 2	The developer has provided sufficient clarification on the strategies being implemented to address behavioral barriers and track ICS adoption rates. The response outlines structured community incentivization mechanisms, including active engagement. PP will plan to capture success stories and testimonials further demonstrate efforts to promote sustained ICS usage. The information provided is adequate to close the finding. #closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (Cl 5)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Anti – discrimination	Section 2.2.2 The report states that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd ensures equal opportunity employment and non-discriminatory access to ICS distribution regardless of gender, race, religion, or educational background. However, the section does not describe the actual processes implemented to enforce anti-discrimination and prevent harassment or bias in project operations. - The report does not state whether specific safeguards are in place to prevent sexual harassment during project implementation. - The report does not specify how compliance with non-discrimination policies is ensured	TEM's stand on discrimination and harassment is very clear. An excerpt is taken from TEM's Employee Handbook on the Principle of Equality: "TEM is committed to providing equal opportunities and the principle of equality in accordance with relevant legislative provisions. The company will not tolerate any unlawful discriminatory act or attitude in the course of any employment or in any dealings with clients, suppliers, contractors, members of the public or fellow colleagues. Acts of unlawful discrimination, harassment or victimisation will result in disciplinary action." This is further mentioned in Sections 13 (Bullying and Harassment) and 14 (Equal Opportunities and Anti-Discrimination) of the TEM Employee Handbook (VCS 4416-TEM 2023_Employee Handbook.pdf) where definitions of harassment and discrimination, along with its consequences is clearly stated. This ensures that any form of harassment or bias in project operations are prevented. This handbook clearly articulates the code of conduct and expected behaviours of all full-time staff employed with TEM in the different countries were activities take place including the PNG Cookstove project. For the field implementation team, who are hired as casual staff for TEM, a PNG Employee Handbook Policy (VCS 4416-PNG Employee Handbook V1.2 2024.pdf) is provided that explains the code of

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (Cl 5)	Developer Response
			conduct and fair working practices, supplemented with trainings (VCS 4416-PNG Staff Training 4 days.pdf, Session 11 onwards) which have dedicated modules on preventing sexual harassment and anti-discrimination. In the case of any grievances related to discrimination or harassment during project implementation, a Grievance Redress Mechanism is developed to be used by all employees and contractors. (VCS 4416-TEM 2023_GRM ICS_Final_Formatted.pdf). Files for easy reference: File Name: • VCS 4416-TEM 2023_GRM ICS_Final_Formatted.pdf • VCS 4416-TEM 2023_Employee Handbook.pdf • VCS 4416-PNG Employee Handbook V1.2 2024.pdf
	Rd 2	While the PP has described appropriate safeguards and mechanisms to address discrimination and harassment, including the implementation of a Grievance Redress Mechanism, the report does not confirm whether any grievances related to discrimination, harassment, or bias have been received during the monitoring period. PP shall confirm if any grievances related to discrimination or harassment were received during the current monitoring period, and if so,	During the monitoring period, no grievances relating to discrimination or harassment were received. If there is ever such an issue raised during future monitoring periods, it will be raised and addressed in accordance with TEM's Grievance Redress Mechanism (VCS 4416-TEM 2023_GRM ICS_Final_Formatted.pdf) in a statement (verbal or written) or expression of grief, pain, or dissatisfaction regarding an impact or effect on the complainant arising from the ICS project.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 5)	Developer Response
		provide a summary of how they were addressed. #open	To ensure TEM's accountability and transparency and to clearly support the project initiatives, complaints by the individual will be received and registered by the in-country Project manager through its field assistants and coordinators. If the grievance is not resolved at this level, they will escalate to TEM management where a response will then be provided to the complainant or to the concerned stakeholder.
	Rd3	The project proponent has confirmed that no grievances related to discrimination or harassment were received during the current monitoring period. Furthermore, the proponent has outlined a clear and structured grievance redress mechanism to ensure any future issues will be addressed in a transparent and accountable manner. This mechanism ensures appropriate escalation and resolution pathways are available to affected individuals. Therefore, the finding stands closed. #closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 6)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Worker training	Section 2.2.3 The report outlines that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd conducted a two-day training course for the in-country team on monitoring techniques, data recording, and quality control.	The local team for the project is comprised of native people living in the project area of our proposed activities. Thus, training activities were tailored to span a broad range of literacy levels and disabilities within the team. Training for field assistants was

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 6)	Developer Response
		Workers also received technical skills training and education on regulations, management structure, and worker rights. However, the report lacks details on inclusivity, capacity-building, and long-term skill retention. The report does not specify if specialized training was provided for marginalized or vulnerable groups (e.g., women, indigenous populations, or persons with disabilities).	initially completed through a 4-day training workshop conducted by TEM in July 2024 (VCS 4416-PNG Staff Training 4 days.pdf). To ensure long-term skill retention, a two-day refresher training was organised in January 2025 prior to the monitoring. To ensure continuity and promote capacity building, refresher trainings will be frequently organised for the field teams during every monitoring period. Following fairness, inclusive opportunities, staff were asked whether any specific requirements were need before training. Based on the answer, all the staff underwent the same training on technical skills, ethical considerations for data collection following with in country standards. This is seen by 37.50% (VCS 4416-SD VISTa - Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet v1.2.xlsx) of the individuals trained being female, whereas one of our staff is a person with disabilities.
	Rd 2	PP has provided sufficient clarification regarding the inclusivity, capacity-building, and long-term skill retention measures related to worker training. Training records have been submitted and verified by the assessment team, Based on the information and supporting evidence provided, the finding is considered resolved.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 6)	Developer Response
		#closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Equal work opportunity	Section 2.2.4 The report states that equal employment opportunities were provided regardless of gender, race, religion, or educational background and that recruitment advertisements were made available in Pidgin English for accessibility. However, no supporting data or verification details are provided to confirm the fairness and inclusivity of the hiring process. Demographic breakdown of hired staff (percentage of women, persons with disabilities, and marginalized groups). Confirmation of whether affirmative action policies (e.g., quotas, outreach programs) were implemented to promote diversity in hiring.	Section 2.2.4 TEM is committed to providing equal opportunities and the principle of equality in accordance with relevant legislative provisions. The recruitment process in PNG was conducted fairly with the support of a renowned recruitment agency, Vanguard International (PNG), that facilitated the recruiting, training and contracting processes for our casual and full-time employees according to TEM's Job Description and Equal Opportunities & Anti-discrimination Policy found in the TEM Employee Handbook, Section 14 and in alignment within country policies and regulations for employment. While TEM has not implemented a formal affirmative action policy, diversity considerations were incorporated throughout the recruitment process. This approach resulted in achieving a 37.50% female staff representation across implementation teams—a notable achievement within Papua New Guinea's traditional patriarchal society. (VCS 4416- SDVISTa -Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet v1.2.xlsx)

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
		Section 2.2.5 The report states that all in-country personnel signed labour contracts aligned with PNG labour legislation and ILO Core Labour Conventions. It also mentions that contract terms were explained explicitly before signing. However, the report does not provide evidence of enforcement or worker compliance verification. A sample labour contract used in the project. Confirmation of mechanisms available to workers for reporting labour rights violations or grievances.	For full demographic breakdown of staff during the monitoring period, please refer to the following file provided: VCS 4416-PNG Cookstoves Employee Breakdown and Analysis.xlsx Files Provided: • Signed Agreement with Vanguard File name: VCS 4416-20240304_Proposal for recruitment 26.02.2024.pdf • TEM's Job Descriptions File Name: - VCS 4416-20240123_Position Description - IT & Data Manager.pdf - VCS 4416-20240123_Position Description - Operations Manager.pdf - VCS 4416- Position Description - Field Coordinator.pdf • TEM Employee Handbook Folder: Anti-Discrimination File Name: VCS 4416- EM 2023_Employee Handbook.pdf Section 2.2.5 A sample of the labour contract used in the project for casual and full-time staff is provided. Folder Direction: Equal Work Opportunities > Full-Timers Folder Direction: Equal Work Opportunities > Casual

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
		Section 2.2.6 The report states that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd mitigates occupational safety risks by hiring local workers familiar with community environments and conducting safety awareness sessions. It also mentions training for new hires and refresher courses for existing workers. However, no specific safety measures, risk mitigation strategies, or verification data are provided. List of specific safety hazards identified and how they were mitigated.	Please note that these contracts are confidential and should not be shared outside the relationship between TEM and Sustain-Cert. Each employee is placed in teams with a clear role and responsibilities, and a hierarchy for reporting. During the onboarding process, the employees (regardless of position) receive training on work health and safety procedure including reporting of any labour rights violations or grievances through well-established channels. File for easy reference: Folder Name: Anti-Discrimination File Name: VCS 4416-TEM 2023_GRM ICS_Final_Formatted.pdf Folder Name: Training File Name: VCS 4416-PNG Staff Training 4 days.pdf (Session 4: Roles of the Field Team) Section 2.2.6: TEM ensures safe and appropriate working conditions for all its employees through the development and consultation of its Project Risk Assessment (Refer to file name: VCS 4416-PNG Cookstove Project Risk Assessment_090924.xlsx). Within this assessment, risks related to transportation and security were identified for all the different stakeholders of the project including TEM staff, the consequences of risks to occur and their

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
		Section 2.2.7 The report states that a Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) has been developed and made publicly available on the project website. Additionally, grievances will be addressed through traditional and customary ways by the in-country Project Manager and field assistants. However, no evidence of GRM effectiveness, grievance registration system, or community awareness activities is provided.	likelihood of them happening is stated via an impact score. Then, mitigation actions for these risks are included to reduce the residual risk to acceptable levels. Additionally, all personnel (native, national and international) travelling to the project boundary must adhere to the tailored security travel plans that are developed with clear emergency protocols to guarantee their safety. (Refer to file name: VCS 4416_ICS-distribution travel plan-week 10_Approved.pdf) The travel plan includes details for Remote Check-Ins with a designated Check-In person, full travel itinerary, emergency contact details, etc. The travel plan must be pre-approved by TEM's Director of International Projects before they are circulated to all parties participating in the trip. All documents can be found in the SharePoint Folder: Safety and Travel Plans Please note that these documents contain sensitive information such as emergency contact details of persons not employed under TEM, are confidential and should not be shared outside the relationship between TEM and Sustain-Cert. Section 2.2.7

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
		Confirmation of whether any complaints were received and how they were resolved (even if none were formally registered, mention any informal feedback recorded). Section 2.3.1 The report states that TEM PNG Cookstoves Project Pte Ltd follows strict anti-corruption policies and that any violations result in immediate termination of engagement. However, no details are provided on the enforcement, monitoring, or reporting mechanisms for corruption prevention. Details on how corruption risks are monitored (e.g., internal audits, third-party verifications). Confirmation of whether a whistleblower mechanism exists for reporting corruption and how complaints are handled.	To ensure TEM's accountability and transparency and to clearly support the project activities, complaints by an affected party will be received and registered by the in-country Project Manager through his field assistants and coordinators. If the grievances are not resolved at this level, it will be escalated to the TEM's in country project manager where a response will be provided to the compliant or the concerned stakeholder. During the monitoring period, no formal complaints were received or logged from the end-users in the form of physical walk ins, social media and online postings or phone calls, and verbally through community representatives. Verbal feedback has been very positive, while one feedback was made in the presence of the validator during the site visit regarding smoke from open fire cooking being able to maintain the waterproofing of the end-user's dwelling. However, as this perception of using the project ICS in lieu of open fire cooking cannot be scientifically proven, this feedback has been recorded as informal feedback. File for easy reference: Folder Name: Anti-Discrimination File Name: VCS 4416-TEM 2023_GRM ICS_Final_Formatted.pdf Section 2.3.1

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (Cl 7)	Developer Response
			All TEM employees adhere to the Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy Laws to protect both themselves and the reputation of the company. Under this policy, TEM employees are not permitted to give, offer, promise, accept, request, or authorise a bribe, whether directly or indirectly or abuse entrusted power for private gain. Any gifts received by the employee should, where possible, be discussed with their manager before being accepted, noting that gifts/benefits should not be accepted on a re-occurring basis or broken down into parts of less than $100. Record-keeping and Monitoring Financial records of donations or expenditures to third parties are recorded and must have evidence and business reason for making payments. Whistle Blower Mechanism The whistle blower mechanism is found in the TEM Employee Handbook, applied to all TEM Employees, and is governed under The Corporations Act 2001 (Cth) which provides protections for certain types of persons that make a disclosure of Reportable Conduct.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (Cl 7)	Developer Response
			This policy has been put in place to ensure employees and other Disclosers can raise concerns regarding any misconduct or improper state of affairs or circumstances of TEM (including any related entities of TEM) (TEM) without being subject to victimisation, harassment or discriminatory treatment. Where there is a grievance, employees of TEM would report the Reportable Conduct to their relevant Senior Manager by telephone or email. Upon receiving a report, the relevant Senior Manager/s of TEM will determine if the report relates to Reportable Conduct and, if so, the report will be investigated as appropriate. The investigation may be conducted internally or via an externally appointed investigator. All reasonable steps will be taken to protect a Discloser's identity following a report of any matter that is considered Reportable Conduct. File for easy reference: Folder Name: Anti-Discrimination File Name: VCS 4416- TEM 2023_Anti Bribery and Corruption Policy.pdf
	Rd 2	PP has provided the detail and sufficient evidence, it has been confirmed that the employee handbook covers the major points and and has been implemented, it has also been	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 7)	Developer Response
		discussed with the stakeholders during the interview process during onsite visit. There has been sufficient information provided therefore, the finding stands closed. #closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CI 8)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Policy	Section 2.3.8 The report provides a list of international and Papua New Guinea (PNG) laws, regulations, and conventions that the project aligns with, including UNFCCC, the United Nations Declaration on Indigenous Rights, the Paris Agreement, and various national forestry, environmental, and labor laws. However, no verification is provided on compliance mechanisms or enforcement. PP shall demonstrate Examples of specific project actions that demonstrate compliance with stated laws (e.g., forest conservation activities aligning with the Forestry Act, carbon credit registration under PNG's Climate Change Management Act).	Any major change in the listed laws will be reviewed and updated in each monitoring period. The project has ensured compliance with national, provincial and local level governments through stakeholder consultations during all phases (i.e. project design, development and implementation). No-objection letters (NOLs) from local level governments, PNG Forestry and Climate Change Management Division (CCDA) are available for verification in the folder below. Folder Name: Policy File: CCDA Letter of Receipt (Signed) File Name: VCS 4416-LOR CCDA.pdf File: PNGFA Letter of Receipt (Signed) File Name: VCS 4416-LOR PNGFA.pdf

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (Cl 8)	Developer Response
			Folder Name No-Objection Letters from Local Level Governments (LLGs) File Name: • VCS 4416-NOL EHP.pdf • VCS 4416-NOL Jiwaka.pdf • VCS 4416-NOL SHP.pdf • VCS 4416-NOL WHP.pdf
	Rd 2	PP has provided sufficient evidence to demonstrate compliance with relevant international and national laws, including Papua New Guinea's forestry and climate change regulations. Signed no-objection letters (NOLs) from the PNG Forestry Authority, the Climate Change and Development Authority (CCDA), and local-level governments confirm official acknowledgment and support for the project. It has been verified that adequate evidences have been provided, therefore the finding is considered closed. #Closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CAR 1)	Developer Response
	Template Guidelines	On the cover page: PP shall complete form form in line with template guidelines: Complete all items in the box on the title page using Arial or Franklin Gothic Book 10.5	Format on the cover page has been edited accordingly.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CAR 1)	Developer Response
		point, black, regular (non-italic) font. Dates of registration or completion of project design evaluation, earlier verifications or project implementation evaluations In the Excel sheet: Monitoring Period dates mentioned in the SD vista monitoring excel sheet shall be corrected in line with MP dates in Monitoring report. In the section 1: As per the template guidelines, Brief description of the cumulative quantifiable impact of the project's activities related to the SDG indicator, during the project lifetime shall be provided in the column 2 of the report. In the section 2.1.5 PP shall not alter the template, PP shall make sure the template is intact For the entire report: PP shall make sure the template remains intact, shall correct the footer section of the report.	Monitoring Period (MP) dates mentioned in the SD Vista monitoring excel sheet has been corrected to be aligned with MP in the Monitoring report. In section 1 of the template guidelines, column 2 has been updated to just reflect the cumulative quantifiable impact over the project's lifetime. In section 2.1.5, the table has been re-included to ensure that the template is not altered. For the entire report, the template remains intact.
	Rd 2	PP has revised the MR as per the template guidelines, however, the footer is still not inline,	Footer has been amended to be in line with the template guidelines.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CAR 1)	Developer Response
		PP shall revise the MR. #Open	
	Rd3	PP has revised the monitoring report inline with template guidelines.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 9)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard	Excel sheet	In the Excel sheet “VCS 4416-SDVISTa - Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet v1.2.xlsx”, we would like to seek clarification regarding the responses in Columns O, P, and Q under tab processed tab data. In Column O, the question is: "Do you still use your open-fire cooking method?" — some beneficiaries responded "Yes", and others "No". Moving to Column P: "Stovestacking: How many of your meals are cooked per week using the Improved Cookstove?" — many respondents who answered "Yes" in Column O mentioned that all meals are cooked using the improved cookstove.	Stove-stacking is defined as the concurrent use of multiple stoves in regions where efforts to transition household energy to cleaner stoves/or fuels are on-going5. It is possible for one meal to be cooked with more than one type of cookstove, i.e. dish A on open fire and dish B on ICS. The responses in the monitoring survey spreadsheet are consistent with the above scenario as it also captures instances when households are using open fire cooking methods simultaneously alongside the ICS. This is a more conservative approach than defining stacking only as the cases where the ICS is not used to prepare a meal.

[5] Shankar AV, Quinn A, Dickinson KL, Williams KN, Masera O, Charron D, Jack D, Hyman J, Pillarisetti A, Bailis R, Kumar P, Ruiz-Mercado I, Rosenthal J. Everybody Stacks: Lessons from household energy case studies to inform design principles for clean energy transitions. Energy Policy. 2020 Jun;141:111468. doi: 10.1016/j.enpol.2020.111468. Epub 2020 Apr 8. PMID: 32476710; PMCID: PMC7259482.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 9)	Developer Response
		However, in Column Q: "Stovestacking: How many of those meals are cooked per day using the Open-Fire Cooking method?" — most of those same beneficiaries reported cooking less than half a meal using the open-fire method. This appears to be inconsistent. If all meals are being cooked using the improved cookstove, PP shall clarify why some meals are still being reported as cooked using the open-fire method Cell G22 of SDG Target 1.1, mentions MP1, PP shall be revised the statement Based on the data provided, it is noted that in the cumulative results, only 80% of the population is using the commissioned ICS devices, while 20% are not. However, in the batch-wise breakdown: Batch 1: 100% usage (45 out of 45 households) Batch 2: 100% usage (51 out of 51 households) This indicates a discrepancy between the cumulative and batch-wise usage figures. Why does the cumulative proportion reflect only 80% ICS usage while both Batch 1 and Batch 2 individually show 100% usage?	In sheet SDG Target 1.1, where applicable, MP1 has been changed to Batch 1 and MP2 has been changed to Batch 2. An incorrect formula in the sheet “Processed Raw Data” was causing the cumulative and batch-wise results to be different. It has been corrected and now correctly shows the cumulative proportion of project devices to be a 100%, aligning with both Batch 1 and 2. Additional Files Provided: SD VISTA Monitoring Spreadsheet (Updated): VCS 4416-SD VISTa -Monitoring Plan Spreadsheet v2.xlxs

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (CL 9)	Developer Response
		The project proponent has clarified that the survey responses reflect stove-stacking behavior, where multiple cookstove types may be used concurrently within a single household. The seemingly inconsistent data entries are aligned with the broader and more conservative interpretation of stove-stacking, which includes simultaneous use of open fire and ICS for different parts of the same or different meals. This explanation sufficiently addresses the perceived discrepancy in the monitoring data. Therefore, the finding stands closed. The discrepancy between the cumulative and batch-wise ICS usage figures has been addressed. The project proponent identified an incorrect formula in the “Processed Raw Data” sheet that resulted in an underreported cumulative proportion. The formula has since been corrected, and the updated spreadsheet now reflects 100% ICS usage cumulatively, consistent with the batch-wise figures for both Batch 1 and Batch 2. Therefore, the finding stands. #closed.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (FAR 1)	Developer Response
SDVISTA Standard		The VVB shall verify the claims made by the PP for SDG 1 incorporates:	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments (FAR 1)	Developer Response
		- Integrate survey questions into future monitoring surveys to directly capture information on monetary savings experienced by households due to the use of improved cookstoves - Report on the outcomes of these survey responses in the next monitoring report to substantiate SDG 1 contributions made by the project.	

APPENDIX 3: ABBREVIATIONS

MR	Monitoring report
PD	Project description
MP	Monitoring Period
PP	Project Proponent
PAI	Project Instances
ICS	Improved Cook Stove
VCS	Verified Carbon Standard
VVB	Validation and Verification Body
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
VCU	Verified Carbon Unit
IPCC	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
AQI	Acceptable Quality Level
UQL	Unacceptable Quality Level
GP	Grouped Project
CHW	Community Health Worker

APPENDIX 4: COMPETENCE STATEMENT

Competency Statement	
Name	Muskan Chawla
Years of Experience	2.5+
Qualifying Roles	
Team Leader	Yes
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English) / CE Region 6 (Hindi)
Technical Expert	Yes (1.2, 3.1)
Financial Expert	No
Independent Reviewer	Yes
Approval	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	5/9/2023

Competency Statement	
Name	Hayden Wagia
Years of Experience	-
Qualifying Roles	
Team Leader	No
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, Papua New Guinea
Technical Expert	Yes (3.1)
Financial Expert	No

Independent Reviewer	No
Approval	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	03/02/2025

COMPETENCY STATEMENT	
Name	Shivraj Sharma
Years of Experience	19+
QUALIFYING ROLES	
Team Leader	Yes
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English) / CE Region 6 (Hindi)
Technical Expert	Yes (1.1, 1.2)
Financial Expert	Yes
Independent Reviewer	Yes
APPROVAL	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	15/07/2022